

Roof Terrace — Planting Plan

Flat 6, 22 Sussex Square, Brighton BN2 5AA · Issued for nursery review — 30 August 2026 (rev B, after design review)

What we're asking for. This is the planting plan for a new roof terrace on a Grade I listed building on the Brighton seafront. We would like you to **review it, tell us where we've got it wrong, suggest substitutions, confirm supply sizes and availability, and price it** — plants, bulbs, pots and the composter.

The client is not a plantsman and will be **planting this himself. Please push back** — if a species won't do what we think it will in this exposure, if a supply size is wrong, or if you'd do something better, we want to hear it. §18 collects the questions we'd most value your view on.

220 plants · 1,795 bulbs and corms · 22 pots · 26.4 m² of planter. Every plant is tagged with where it came from: **Sussex Square** (found growing in the communal gardens here), **Springfield Road** (from the client's previous garden), or **New** (chosen for this site).

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1. The idea

Three storeys above the seafront, on the roof of a Regency terrace, with the Channel on one side and the Downs on the other. Whatever goes up here has to survive salt wind from every direction — and it has to look as though it has always been there, on a Grade I listed building in the Kemp Town Enclosures.

So the scheme takes its cue from two places. The first is the communal gardens of Sussex Square itself: a survey of them turns up the same plants over and over — rosemary, lavender, cotton lavender, Mediterranean spurge, catmint, red valerian, silver-leaved sub-shrubs baking against warm brick. That is the Kemp Town vernacular, and it is also, conveniently, exactly what thrives in a shallow gritty container in a salt gale. The second is the client's own previous garden, which contributes the plants he already knows and loves and which happen to translate: the fine-leaved pittosporum, the cheddar-pink lavenders, *Cistus* 'Alan Fradd', *Abelia*, *Hebe rakaiensis*, the Byzantine gladiolus, the species tulips. **Every plant in this document is tagged with where it came from** — Sussex Square, Springfield Road, or newly chosen for the site.

What it should feel like. Not a roof garden of specimen pots. A silvered, low, wind-combed thing that looks as if it grew out of the shingle — the planting equivalent of the weathered timber and buff granite it sits in. Silver and grey-green foliage almost everywhere; flowers restricted to blue, purple and white, with yellow allowed only where a plant earns it (*Euphorbia*, *Phlomis*, *Coronilla*). Clipped evergreen domes repeat through it to hold the composition together in February, and everything else spills loosely between and over them.

What it should smell like. This matters as much as how it looks. Rosemary and thyme at every edge, so walking anywhere releases something. Lavender through the middle of summer. Myrtle by the hot tub, which smells of nothing until you crush a leaf. The oleaster's tiny invisible flowers in late October, which scent that whole end of the terrace and which almost nobody can identify. And, in the sheltered corner by the study door where the sun barely reaches in winter, *Sarcococca* and *Daphne odora* in January — the two most powerful winter scents there are, put deliberately where you brush past them on the way out in the dark.

A year on the terrace.

December–January	Bare and structural, and that is the test the scheme is built to pass. Clipped domes, silver mounds, standing seed heads. <i>Sarcococca</i> and <i>Daphne</i> scenting the study door. <i>Coronilla</i> already in pale lemon flower. <i>Iris unguicularis</i> opening lilac at the foot of the sunny east planter. The first snowdrops in the shaded pots
February–March	The month everything starts. Four hundred crocus opening through the gravel, dwarf irises in deep blue, rosemary flowering blue along every edge, <i>Euphorbia wulfenii</i> throwing up acid-green heads. Daffodils, short ones that don't snap
April–May	Species tulips — small, jewel-like, and they come back each year. <i>Muscari</i> in drifts. White 'Thalia' daffodils. Then the alliums: purple drumsticks standing on leafless stems through the wind, and magenta Byzantine gladiolus among them. <i>Cistus</i> opens white with a maroon blotch
June–July	The full Mediterranean summer. Lavender and catmint everywhere, <i>Phlomis</i> in yellow whorls, sea holly in steel blue, <i>Hebe</i> spikes, thyme swarming with bees, blue oat grass moving in the wind
August–September	Myrtle flowers white and scented; <i>Abelia</i> takes over the late nectar; <i>Salvia yangii</i> throws a blue haze over silver stems; <i>Hylotelephium</i> turns dusky pink. <i>Aster</i> carries the butterflies
October–November	The oleaster's tiny hidden flowers scent the east side — the strongest and least identifiable perfume of the year. <i>Nerine</i> comes up pink out of bare gravel. Allium and <i>Eryngium</i> seed heads go silver and stay standing until February

And what it is designed *not* to do. Not to block the Downs. Not to need clipping on a face nobody can reach. Not to drop its clippings on the neighbours. Not to generate more green waste than can be carried down through the flat. Not to need feeding into softness. Those constraints did more to shape this scheme than any aesthetic preference, and the sections that follow explain each one.

2. The site, its levels and its edges

A new roof terrace of about 120 m², three storeys up on the Kemp Town seafront. Roughly **26.4 m²** is planted, in timber planters built on top of the finished granite paving, plus 22 pots.

Condition	What it means for the planting
Exposure	Salt-laden wind off the Channel, unobstructed on all four sides. The prevailing and strongest wind is south-westerly ; the cold desiccating one is north-easterly in spring
Aspect	Full sun across almost the whole terrace. The exception is the south end of the narrow terrace — planter N4 and pot Groups A, B and E — where the flat rises about 3m immediately to the south. Good light, much less direct sun, especially in winter
Access	No vehicle access to the terrace. An internal lift reaches the floor below (one flight of stairs up); bulk and specimens go up the scaffold hoist or by crane — see §15
Soil	Peat-free lightweight roof-garden mix over a drainage layer. Deliberately lean and sharply drained
Planter depth	Mostly 600mm ; the SE L-shape (M2) is 1,000mm ; the lift-over-run bed (N4) is 400mm
Water	Automatic drip irrigation on three zones — §13
Winter	Mild and coastal, rarely below −3°C. Wind desiccation and salt, not frost, are what kill here

The windbreak principle

A barrier of roughly **50% porosity** shelters the ground for **10–15 times its own height** downwind, whereas a solid barrier shelters less and throws a turbulent eddy behind it. So the back rows are **dense-but-twiggy evergreens** at 0.8–1.0m centres, knitting into a **filtering** screen rather than a wall. **If you disagree with this reading, please say so.**

Two layers, not three, in a 600mm planter. A 1.5m evergreen at the back of a 600mm box occupies the full width at maturity and shades out anything in front. So the 600mm runs are a back row plus a front ribbon, with mid-height shrubs substituted into the back row wherever we want to see over. Only M2, at 1,000mm deep, carries a genuine third layer.

Levels, parapets and railings — the numbers that set every height

The terrace is not one level and not one edge condition, and both facts drive the heights in §5.

Where	Edge	Height above that area's FFL
Narrow terrace — east and west	Open steel railings, no parapet. Wind passes straight through	1,100mm
Narrow terrace — north end	Solid parapet	1,300mm
Main terrace — south of the sauna's south wall (dining deck raised 300mm; all of M2 sits here)	Solid parapet	1,000mm
Main terrace — north of the sauna's south wall (lounge and hot tub, low level)	Solid parapet	1,300mm

The parapet is a single continuous height in absolute terms — the 1,000 / 1,300mm difference is the 300mm step up to the dining deck.

Three consequences run through the whole scheme.

1. Containment. Parapet top minus planter height is how much of a shrub is held inboard before it starts leaning out over the drop:

Planter	Planter height	Edge	Held inboard
N1(E)	500mm	open railings, 1,100mm	500mm only — above its own back panel, growth pushes <i>through</i> the bars
N1(N)	500mm	parapet 1,300mm	800mm
M2(E) / M2(S) — all on the raised level	700mm	parapet 1,000mm	300mm
M4 / M7 — low zone	700 / 600mm	parapet 1,300mm	600–700mm

2. A spread rule, not just a height rule. Because so little is contained, mature *width* matters as much as height: **no shrub wider than the planter depth plus about 300mm each side** — roughly 1.2m in the 600mm runs, 1.6m in the 1,000mm-deep M2. It is why *Escallonia* 'Apple Blossom' (1.5–2m wide) appears **only in M2**, and why the 600mm runs carry *Myrtus* and the dwarf *Pittosporum* domes, all of which sit comfortably within 1.2m.

3. The narrow terrace has no low-level shelter at all. Wind whistles straight through the railings below 1,100mm. On the main terrace a solid parapet gives you a metre of still air before the planting even begins; on the narrow terrace it does not. So N1(E)'s planting is not *supplementing* a windbreak — from ground level up, it **is** the windbreak. Growth pushing through the railing bars between 500mm and 1,100mm is expected and welcome: it softens the railings and reads as green from outside.

 **Worth checking separately — not a planting matter.** The narrow-terrace railings measure **1,100mm above the current FFL**, which is exactly the Approved Document K guarding height. The new warm-roof build-up will raise that FFL slightly, and even 30mm takes the railings below 1,100mm. Worth re-measuring

once the build-up is set and confirming with Ronan and Building Control, since the specification currently assumes no guarding top-up is needed.

The constraint that shaped the shrub palette

No planter's back face can be reached. On the main terrace it is against a solid parapet; on the narrow terrace it is against open railings with a drop beyond. Anything clipped there would fall into the street or onto a neighbour below. Growth escaping over the parapet would also foul the bird-deterrent wires and show in the Bristol Gardens view the planning officers flagged.

So the shrub palette is built around **plants that hold their own shape**, not plants that are clipped into shape. Nothing in the scheme is a hedging plant. As a working rule, a shrub's natural mature width should be no more than the planter depth plus a modest overhang.

Maintenance demand	Plants
None — naturally self-limiting domes	<i>Myrtus communis</i> subsp. <i>tarentina</i> , <i>Pittosporum</i> 'Golf Ball' and 'Tom Thumb', <i>Hebe</i> 'Rakaiensis', <i>Convolvulus cneorum</i> , <i>Cistus</i> , <i>Coronilla</i> , <i>Phillyrea angustifolia</i> , <i>Euphorbia myrsinites</i> , <i>Armeria</i> , <i>Dianthus</i> , <i>Festuca</i> , thymes
Light, from the front only	<i>Euphorbia wulfenii</i> (cut spent stems at the base each June), <i>Phlomis</i> and <i>Santolina</i> (one shear after flowering), lavenders and <i>Nepeta</i> (shear, never into old wood), <i>Helictotrichon</i> (comb out dead leaves in spring), all perennials (cut at the base in February)
Occasional reduction, from the front	<i>Escallonia</i> 'Apple Blossom' and <i>Abelia</i> — informal shrubs, reduced every second or third year, never sheared
 Annual work	<i>Atriplex halimus</i> and <i>Elaeagnus × ebbingei</i> — reduced hard back every spring, once a year, from the front. And the two <i>Pittosporum</i> 'Silver Sheen' specimens — supplied crown-lifted , then tipped back annually from the front, always cutting <i>inward</i>

When you do cut near a parapet: work in still weather, and clip into a bag or over a groundsheet laid inside the planter. Never lean over the parapet. Anything that has escaped beyond the parapet line gets cut back to it each spring.

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3. Layout drawings

 **Orientation:** these drawings are rotated 90° clockwise. **RIGHT = NORTH · LEFT = SOUTH · TOP = WEST · BOTTOM = EAST.**

Whole terrace — the narrow terrace runs south to north from the flat, opening into the main terrace at the north end. Planters labelled N1–N4 and M1 / M2 / M4 / M7.



Main section — dining deck (raised 300mm), sauna and wet room, hot tub, and the lounge.



4. View corridors and height caps

The Downs are the reason this terrace faces the way it does, and the planting must not eat the view. Five sightlines govern the heights in §5. **Where a corridor and a windbreak conflict, the corridor wins** — that is a deliberate client decision.

#	From	Looking	Rule applied
1	Dining table (raised deck, FA2)	North-east, to the Downs	Nothing above ~1m total height in M1(N), M4, the north half of M2(E), or pot Groups C and D. The tall planting on this terrace sits <i>behind</i> the diner — M1(W) and M2(S) — where it shelters without obstructing
2	Sauna door and window	East and north-east, to the Downs	M4 capped at 1m maximum above finished floor level, tapering lower at its east end
3	Hot tub	East, to the Downs	Kept completely open. There is deliberately no planter on the tub's east or north side , and the five pots east of the tub (Group C) are all low aromatics
4	(reverse) Neighbours' upper windows, east / north-east	Down into the hot tub	Blocked at high level by layers: the Phase-2 parasols when open; one airy multi-stem olive at the north end of M2(E), canopy ~2.0–2.7m above the rim, filtering the diagonal whenever they're not. You see under and through it; it takes the directness out of the sightline rather than walling it off
5	(reverse) Both parasol masts (Phase 2)	—	Nothing tall within the canopies' opening sweep or furled drop zones: M1(W)'s tall backbone sits at the SOUTH end of its run, away from the dining mast station; Group D sets out around the sofa mast after it is in. Canopy undersides run ~2.1–2.4m above their deck — everything under the sweep stays below ~1.8m

Corridor 4 is layered, not solved once. The parasols do the heavy lifting when they're open — but they won't always be open, so the olive stands there permanently as a filter. And note the parasols cover the dining table and the sofas, **not the tub itself** — which is why the olive earns its place.

Two consequences worth being explicit about:

1. **M4 doubles as a windbreak.** Its cap is 1m **above the planter rim** — 1.7m above finished floor level — so the west end carries evergreen domes that give the lounge real shelter from the north-east, while the east end drops to mats where the sauna's sightline is tightest.
2. **M2(E) is entirely on the raised level**, where the parapet stands 1,000mm above FFL — only 300mm above the planter rim. So the understorey in its north half is capped at **300mm from the rim**: mats and cushions only, nothing that would break the line of the coping. [↑ Contents](#)

5. The planting, planter by planter

Each planter opens with what it is *for* and how it should feel through the year, then what actually goes in it. Plant names link directly to their RHS entry. Quantities may be adjusted $\pm 10\%$ on site against the actual run lengths — please price the totals in §11.

+ RHS open-ground sizes; in these lean containers expect roughly two-thirds of that.

N1(E) — Narrow terrace — east side

7.2m long × 600mm deep · **500mm high · open steel railings, 1,100mm above FFL — no parapet**

The long east flank, and the first thing you see when you step out of the study. Seven metres of silvered timber with a loose twiggy evergreen wall behind it: a single **Silver Sheen** pittosporum standing above the rest, two myrtles and two purple-bronze domes knitting together into a screen the wind can pass *through* rather than pile against. In February the rosemary is already blue and there are crocus at your feet. By June it is lavender, catmint and blue oat grass moving in the wind, with *Erigeron* daisies seeding themselves into the paving joints. July brings drumstick alliums up through it all on leafless stems that don't mind the gale. Autumn is stonecrop going dusky pink then rust, and the seed heads stay standing until you cut them in February.

Why it is planted this way. The principal screen against being overlooked from the east, and — because the east side has **open railings, not a parapet** — the *only* wind defence the narrow terrace has from that direction. Wind passes straight through the railings at low level, so this planting is the windbreak. Every shrub is a naturally self-limiting dome of no more than ~1.2m spread: nothing that needs clipping, and nothing that will cantilever far past the railing line. After the design review the ribbon here was consolidated into drifts of a few species rather than one-of-everything — it reads as designed planting, and it knits faster.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Back row — windbreak, 0.8–1.0m centres

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i></u> <u>'Silver Sheen'</u> — Kohuhu Springfield Rd	4–8m × 2.5–4m ⁺	May– Jun	Fine silver-green; filters wind — furnished to the base	20–30L · 1.75–2.0m · furnished to the base

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Myrtus communis</i> subsp. <i>tarentina</i></u> — Compact myrtle New	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jul–Sep	Naturally dense dome; needs no clipping at all	5L
1	 <u><i>Phillyrea angustifolia</i></u> — Phillyrea New	2.5–4m × 1.5–2.5m ⁺	May–Jun	Glossy, self-shaping evergreen — the palette was missing it	5L
2	 <u><i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Tom Thumb'</u> — Purple dwarf kohuhu Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	—	Naturally rounded purple-bronze dome, no pruning ever	5L
1	 <u><i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Golf Ball'</u> — Dwarf kohuhu Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	—	Naturally spherical, clipped to 60–80cm; the repeating rhythm	5L
1	 <u><i>Euphorbia characias</i> subsp. <i>wulfenii</i></u> — Mediterranean spurge Sussex Sq	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Feb–May	⚠ Evergreen architecture year-round; sap is an irritant	3–5L
1	 <u><i>Brachyglottis</i> 'Sunshine'</u> — Dunedin daisy bush Sussex Sq	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Silver felted evergreen daisy bush	3L

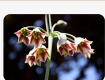
Front ribbon

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
5	 <u><i>Lavandula angustifolia</i> 'Hidcote'</u> — English lavender Springfield Rd	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun– Aug	—	2L
3	 <u><i>Nepeta</i> x <i>faassenii</i> 'Walker's Low'</u> — Catmint Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Jun–Sep	Shear after the first flush	1–2L
3	 <u><i>Stachys byzantina</i> 'Big Ears'</u> — Lamb's ears Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Sep	Silver felted mats; wool carder bees strip the hairs	1L
3	 <u><i>Salvia rosmarinus</i> 'Severn Sea'</u> — Semi-prostrate rosemary Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.5– 1m ⁺	Feb– May	Flowers when almost nothing else does	2L
3	 <u><i>Helictotrichon sempervirens</i></u> — Blue oat grass New	1–1.5m x 0.5– 1m ⁺	Summer	The wind made visible; comb out dead leaves in spring	2L

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
2	 <u><i>Erigeron karvinskianus</i></u> — Mexican fleabane Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Apr–Nov	Self-seeds into paving joints	1L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
25	 <u><i>Allium hollandicum</i></u> 'Purple Sensation' — Ornamental onion	May, purple drumsticks
25	 <u><i>Allium sphaerocephalon</i></u> — Drumstick allium	Jul, wine-purple
25	 <u><i>Narcissus</i></u> 'Tête-à-tête' — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
15	 <u><i>Narcissus</i></u> 'Thalia' — Daffodil	Apr, pure white, 35cm
10	 <u><i>Narcissus</i></u> 'Rijnveld's Early Sensation' — Daffodil	January
15	 <u><i>Tulipa clusiana</i></u> 'Lady Jane' — Lady tulip	Apr, white / rose

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
15	 <u><i>Tulipa saxatilis</i> (Bakeri Gp) 'Lilac Wonder'</u> — Cretan tulip	Apr, lilac-pink, yellow eye
40	 <u><i>Crocus tommasinianus</i></u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
25	 <u><i>Iris reticulata</i> 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin'</u> — Dwarf iris	Feb, deep and pale blue
25	 <u><i>Muscari armeniacum</i> 'Valerie Finnis'</u> — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue
15	 <u><i>Gladiolus communis</i> subsp. <i>byzantinus</i></u> — Byzantine gladiolus	May–Jun, magenta
5	 <u><i>Nectaroscordum siculum</i></u> — Sicilian honey garlic	Jun, cream / green / maroon bells

N1(E) total: **27 plants + 240 bulbs**

N1(N) — Narrow terrace — north leg of the L

1.8m long × 800mm deep · 500mm high · solid parapet 1,300mm above FFL

The turn of the L, and the head of the steps up to the main terrace — so it works as a full stop rather than a run. One multi-stem **olive** does that job, with a myrtle beside it and sea thrift and blue fescue at its feet. The solid parapet behind gives it more shelter than anywhere else on this terrace, which is why the olive goes here rather than out on the exposed run.

Why it is planted this way. The deepest planter on the narrow terrace, so it takes a full specimen — and the solid 1,300mm parapet here gives 800mm of containment above the planter rim, more than anywhere else on the narrow terrace. Marks the head of the L where the steps rise to the main terrace. The olive here is deliberately the smaller 30–35L size — the review confirmed a 45–60L rootball doesn't fit a 500mm box, and in this exposure a smaller tree anchors faster and rocks less.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Back row

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Olea europaea</i></u> — multi-stem — Olive Sussex Sq	4–8m × 1.5–2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Downsized for a 500mm box; anchors faster, rocks less	30–35L · ~1.5m
1	 <u><i>Myrtus communis</i> subsp. <i>tarentina</i></u> — Compact myrtle New	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jul–Sep	Naturally dense dome; needs no clipping at all	5L

Front ribbon

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
3	 <u><i>Armeria maritima</i></u> — Sea thrift New	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Apr–Jun	UK coastal native; evergreen cushions	9cm–1L
2	 <u><i>Festuca glauca</i></u> 'Elijah Blue' — Blue fescue Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Late spring–summer	Blue-grey evergreen tussock; texture all year	1L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
10	 <u><i>Allium hollandicum</i></u> 'Purple Sensation' — Ornamental onion	May, purple drumsticks

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u>Crocus tommasinianus</u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
10	 <u>Narcissus 'Tête-à-tête'</u> — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
10	 <u>Muscari armeniacum 'Valerie Finnis'</u> — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue
10	 <u>Tulipa saxatilis</u> (Bakeri Gp) ' <u>Lilac Wonder</u> ' — Cretan tulip	Apr, lilac-pink, yellow eye

N1(N) total: **7 plants + 60 bulbs**

N2 — Narrow terrace — mid-east square

1.2 × 1.2m · 500mm high · built integral with N1

A punctuation mark in the middle of the east run: one bronze **Phormium** throwing hard vertical sword-leaves out of a soft cushion of lavender and blue fescue. It exists to stop seven metres of planting reading as a hedge. In autumn the stonecrop and a few *Nerine* keep it going after the lavender is over.

Why it is planted this way. A punctuation point in the east run — one piece of architecture with lavender around its feet.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Whole square

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u>Phormium 'Bronze Baby'</u> — Bronze New Zealand flax Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer (rare)	Compact bronze sword foliage — bullet-proof in salt wind	5L
4	 <u>Lavandula angustifolia 'Hidcote'</u> — English lavender Springfield Rd	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Aug	—	2L
2	 <u>Festuca glauca 'Elijah Blue'</u> — Blue fescue Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Late spring– summer	Blue-grey evergreen tussock; texture all year	1L
1	 <u>Hylotelephium 'Matrona'</u> — Stonecrop / iceplant Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Aug–Oct	Seed heads stand all winter	2L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
5	 <u>Allium cristophii</u> — Star of Persia	May–Jun
20	 <u>Crocus tommasinianus</u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
15	 <i>Iris reticulata</i> 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin' — Dwarf iris	Feb, deep and pale blue
10	 <i>Tulipa</i> 'Little Beauty' — Species tulip	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye
10	 <i>Narcissus</i> 'Tête-à-tête' — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
6	 <i>Nerine bowdenii</i> — Guernsey lily	October, pink

N2 total: **8 plants + 66 bulbs**

N3 — Narrow terrace — mid-west square, beside the outdoor kitchen

1.2 × 1.2m · 500mm high

The cook's square, one step from the outdoor kitchen worktop and planted entirely with things you would actually pick — upright rosemary, four kinds of thyme, purple sage, ornamental marjoram that the butterflies mob in August. Evergreen and usable in every month, which is the point: you want to be able to cut something for dinner in January.

Why it is planted this way. The cook's square — everything in it is culinary, and it is one step from the outdoor kitchen worktop.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Whole square

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
2	 <u>Salvia rosmarinus</u> 'Miss Jessopp's Upright' — Upright rosemary Sussex Sq	1.5–2.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Feb–May	Evergreen, culinary	2L
4	 <u>Thymus vulgaris</u> · <u>T. 'Silver Posie'</u> · <u>T. serpyllum</u> — Thyme — 3 forms New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Early summer	Evergreen culinary mats; bees swarm the flowers	9cm
2	 <u>Origanum</u> 'Herrenhausen' — Ornamental marjoram New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Jul–Sep	One of the highest-rated butterfly plants there is	1L
2	 <u>Salvia officinalis</u> 'Purpurascens' — Purple sage New	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer	Culinary; purple foliage sits on the cool palette	2L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u>Crocus</u> 'Snow Bunting' — Crocus	Feb, white, scented
15	 <u>Iris reticulata</u> 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin' — Dwarf iris	Feb, deep and pale blue
10	 <u>Tulipa</u> 'Little Beauty' — Species tulip	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
15	 <i>Allium sphaerocephalon</i> — Drumstick allium	Jul, wine-purple

N3 total: **10 plants + 60 bulbs**

N4 — Lift over-run — the aromatic picking bed

2.1 × 2.1m · **400mm deep box** · planting kept under 700mm

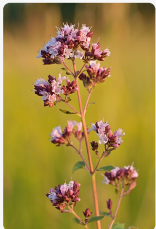
You brush past this every single time you go out, so it is built for scent above everything. A low aromatic mound on top of the lift over-run — prostrate rosemary trailing over all four edges, thyme, lavender, savory, tarragon, sage — with the sun-lovers on the north and east where the light is, and the south edge, in the permanent lee of the flat wall, given over to a different palette entirely: **Sarcococca** and a hellebore, with snowdrops and cyclamen threaded underneath. In January that shaded band is the best-smelling square metre on the terrace. In July the whole thing hums.

Why it is planted this way. You brush past this every time you go out of the study door, so it is built for scent and for picking. **Part-shaded** — the flat rises ~3m immediately to its south — so it is zoned: sun-loving Mediterranean herbs on the north and east sides, and the shade-tolerant plants along the south edge in the lee of the wall.

Mulch and feeding: gravel over the sunny two-thirds. The **shaded south band has no gravel** — it is top-dressed with home-made compost each spring, like the pots. See §12.

South edge — in the lee of the flat wall (part shade)

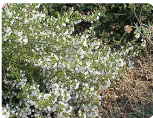
Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <i>Sarcococca hookeriana</i> var. <i>humilis</i> — Sweet box / Christmas box Sussex Sq · Springfield Rd	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Winter	The most powerful winter scent of any hardy shrub	3L

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Helleborus argutifolius</i></u> — Corsican hellebore Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Feb–Apr	Early nectar for waking bumblebees	2L
2	 <u><i>Allium schoenoprasum</i></u> — Chives New	0.1–0.5m × 0–0.1m ⁺	Jun	Culinary; a genuine bee magnet	1L
2	 <u><i>Origanum vulgare</i></u> — Wild marjoram / oregano Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Jul–Sep	UK native; the cooking oregano	1L
1	 <u><i>Rumex acetosa</i></u> — Common sorrel New	0.5–1m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Early summer	Hardy perennial salad leaf, sharp and lemony	1L

North + east edges and body — most direct sun

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
5	 <u><i>Salvia rosmarinus</i> 'Prostratus'</u> — Trailing rosemary Springfield Rd	0.1–0.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Spring–summer	Evergreen, culinary; trails over the planter edges	2L

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
2	 <u>Salvia rosmarinus</u> 'Miss Jessopp's Upright' — Upright rosemary Sussex Sq	1.5–2.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Feb–May	Evergreen, culinary	2L
3	 <u>Lavandula angustifolia</u> 'Hidcote' — English lavender Springfield Rd	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Aug	—	2L
2	 <u>Santolina chamaecyparissus</u> — Cotton lavender Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer	Shear the buds in June if they jar	2L
2	 <u>Salvia microphylla</u> 'Amethyst Lips' — Shrubby sage Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Oct	Blackcurrant-scented leaves when brushed	2L
6	 <u>Thymus vulgaris</u> · <u>T. 'Silver Posie'</u> · <u>T. serpyllum</u> — Thyme — 3 forms New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Early summer	Evergreen culinary mats; bees swarm the flowers	9cm

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
2	 <u>Origanum 'Herrenhausen'</u> — Ornamental marjoram New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Jul–Sep	One of the highest-rated butterfly plants there is	1L
2	 <u>Salvia officinalis</u> — Common sage New	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Early summer	Evergreen grey-green; the cooking sage	2L
2	 <u>Satureja montana</u> — Winter savory New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Summer	Evergreen; pepperiness for beans and stews	1L
2	 <u>Artemisia dracunculus</u> — French tarragon New	0.5–1m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Late summer	⚠ Must be French, not Russian — near-flavourless otherwise	1L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
40	 <u>Crocus tommasinianus</u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
40	 <u>Crocus 'Snow Bunting'</u> — Crocus	Feb, white, scented
30	 <u>Iris reticulata 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin'</u> — Dwarf iris	Feb, deep and pale blue

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
15	 <u>Tulipa clusiana</u> 'Lady Jane' — Lady tulip	Apr, white / rose
15	 <u>Tulipa saxatilis</u> (Bakeri Gp) 'Lilac Wonder' — Cretan tulip	Apr, lilac-pink, yellow eye
10	 <u>Tulipa</u> 'Little Beauty' — Species tulip	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye
30	 <u>Allium sphaerocephalon</u> — Drumstick allium	Jul, wine-purple
25	 <u>Narcissus</u> 'Tête-à-tête' — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
25	 <u>Muscari armeniacum</u> 'Valerie Finnis' — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue
40	 <u>Galanthus nivalis</u> — Snowdrop — buy in the green	Jan–Feb, white
15	 <u>Cyclamen coum</u> — Eastern cyclamen	Jan–Mar, pink / white
10	 <u>Cyclamen hederifolium</u> — Ivy-leaved cyclamen	Sept–Nov, pink / white

N4 total: **35 plants + 295 bulbs**

M1(W) — Main terrace — west edge of the raised dining deck (FA2)

≈4.5m long × 600mm deep · 500mm high, on the +300mm raised deck

The wall behind the dining table, and the south-westerly gale flank — the hardest-working planting on the terrace. A **Silver Sheen** pittosporum furnished to the ground, a myrtle, a purple 'Tom Thumb' dome and a *Brachyglottis*, with *Euphorbia wulfenii* throwing acid-green heads up through them from February. In front, at table height: lavender, catmint, dark-stemmed '**Caradonna**' salvia and silver lamb's ears. Alliums and white 'Thalia' daffodils come through it in spring; *Hylotelephium* holds the autumn.

Why it is planted this way. The south-westerly gale flank and the neighbour side — the hardest-working windbreak on the main terrace, and what you look at from the dining table. It sits **behind** you when you look north-east, so height here does not compete with the Downs view. The Phase-2 dining parasol's mast lands mid-run, just east of this planter. So the two tall backbone plants — the 'Silver Sheen' and the myrtle — go at the SOUTH end of the run, and nothing taller than the front ribbon is planted within about 1.5m either side of the mast station, keeping the canopy's opening sweep and its furled drop zone clear. The *Euphorbia* and the 'Tom Thumb' dome take the north end.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Back row

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Silver Sheen' — Kohuhu Springfield Rd	4–8m × 2.5–4m ⁺	May– Jun	Fine silver-green; filters wind — furnished to the base	20–30L · 1.75–2.0m · furnished to the base
1	 <i>Myrtus communis</i> subsp. <i>tarentina</i> — Compact myrtle New	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jul–Sep	Naturally dense dome; needs no clipping at all	5L

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Tom Thumb' — Purple dwarf kohuhu Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	—	Naturally rounded purple-bronze dome, no pruning ever	5L
1	 <i>Euphorbia characias</i> subsp. <i>wulfenii</i> — Mediterranean spurge Sussex Sq	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Feb– May	⚠ Evergreen architecture year-round; sap is an irritant	3–5L
1	 <i>Brachyglottis</i> 'Sunshine' — Dunedin daisy bush Sussex Sq	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Silver felted evergreen daisy bush	3L

Front ribbon

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
3	 <i>Lavandula angustifolia</i> 'Hidcote' — English lavender Springfield Rd	0.1–0.5m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun– Aug	—	2L
3	 <i>Nepeta</i> × <i>faassenii</i> 'Walker's Low' — Catmint Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Jun– Sep	Shear after the first flush	1–2L

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
3	 <u><i>Salvia nemorosa</i> 'Caradonna'</u> — Balkan clary Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	May–Jul	The sharpest contrast against silver foliage	1–2L
3	 <u><i>Stachys byzantina</i> 'Big Ears'</u> — Lamb's ears Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun– Sep	Silver felted mats; wool carder bees strip the hairs	1L
2	 <u><i>Hylotelephium</i> 'Matrona'</u> — Stonecrop / iceplant Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Aug– Oct	Seed heads stand all winter	2L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u><i>Allium hollandicum</i> 'Purple Sensation'</u> — Ornamental onion	May, purple drumsticks
10	 <u><i>Allium cristophii</i></u> — Star of Persia	May–Jun
20	 <u><i>Narcissus</i> 'Thalia'</u> — Daffodil	Apr, pure white, 35cm

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
15	 <i>Narcissus poeticus</i> var. <i>recurvus</i> — Pheasant's eye	May, white with a red-rimmed eye
15	 <i>Tulipa clusiana</i> 'Lady Jane' — Lady tulip	Apr, white / rose
30	 <i>Crocus tommasinianus</i> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
20	 <i>Muscari armeniacum</i> 'Valerie Finnis' — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue
8	 <i>Nectaroscordum siculum</i> — Sicilian honey garlic	Jun, cream / green / maroon bells

M1(W) total: **19 plants + 138 bulbs**

M1(N) — Main terrace — north edge of the raised dining deck

≈1.1m long × 600mm deep · 500mm high

Deliberately the quietest planter on the terrace. It sits beside the three steps down to the lounge and directly in the north-east view corridor, so it is one clipped **'Golf Ball'** dome and a low skirt of catmint — enough to soften the step edge, not enough to interrupt anything. Crocus and dwarf daffodils in spring, and then it gets out of the way.

Why it is planted this way. Deliberately kept low — this sits beside the three steps down to the lounge, and it is directly in the north-east view corridor from the dining table. **Nothing here above ~1m total.**

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Back

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Golf Ball'</u> — Dwarf kohuhu Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	—	Naturally spherical, clipped to 60–80cm; the repeating rhythm	5L

Front

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
3	 <u><i>Nepeta</i> x <i>faassenii</i> 'Walker's Low'</u> — Catmint Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Jun–Sep	Shear after the first flush	1–2L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
15	 <u><i>Crocus tommasinianus</i></u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
10	 <u><i>Narcissus</i> 'Tête-à-tête'</u> — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
10	 <u><i>Muscari armeniacum</i> 'Valerie Finnis'</u> — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue

M1(N) total: **4 plants + 35 bulbs**

M2(E) — north half — Main terrace, east parapet — north half (≈2.5m)

1,000mm deep · **700mm high planter** · raised level, parapet 1,000mm above FFL

The shingle bank — the most Sussex thing on the roof, on the seaward parapet where it belongs. A single airy multi-stem olive stands at the north end, nearest the hot tub, with nothing but mats beneath it: sea thrift, cheddar pinks, blue fescue, rock samphire and the blue-grey trailing whorls of *Euphorbia myrsinites* — the community of a Sussex shingle beach, transplanted three storeys up. You look straight over it to the Downs. The olive's job is discreet: its canopy, two metres and more above the planter rim, breaks up the diagonal sightline from the neighbours' upper windows down into the tub for the times the parasols are furled. An olive filters rather than blocks — you can see through it, particularly low down, which is exactly the brief.

Why it is planted this way. The review killed the crown-lifted strawberry trees here — the size that screens in year one doesn't exist to buy at sane money, and *Arbutus* sheds fruit and leathery leaves upwind of the tub. But the client still wants standing cover at high level, because the parasols won't always be open. One ordinary multi-stem olive is the answer: bought at 1.75–2.0m it gives real presence around 2.0–2.7m above the rim immediately, its canopy is naturally open (a filter, not a wall), its leaf drop is small-leaved and modest, and it extends the olive language the heritage argument already leans on. The understorey stays capped at 300mm — nothing breaks the line of the coping, and the view east to the Downs is untouched.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Canopy — an airy filter, not a wall

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <i>Olea europaea</i> — multi-stem — Olive Sussex Sq	4–8m × 1.5–2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Ordinary multi-stem — an airy filter, not a wall	45–60L · 1.75–2.0m

Low layer — mats only, nothing above ~300mm from the rim

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
5	 <i>Armeria maritima</i> — Sea thrift New	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Apr–Jun	UK coastal native; evergreen cushions	9cm–1L

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
3	 <u>Dianthus gratianopolitanus</u> — Cheddar pink New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	May–Jul	UK native; strongly clove-scented evergreen mats	1L
3	 <u>Festuca glauca</u> 'Elijah Blue' — Blue fescue Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Late spring–summer	Blue-grey evergreen tussock; texture all year	1L
3	 <u>Euphorbia myrsinites</u> — Myrtle spurge Sussex Sq	up to 10cm x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Mar–May	⚠ Trailing succulent; drapes and never needs cutting	1L
2	 <u>Crithmum maritimum</u> — Rock samphire New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Apr–Sep	UK shingle-shore native; succulent and edible	1L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u>Crocus tommasinianus</u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
15	 <u>Iris reticulata</u> 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin' — Dwarf iris	Feb, deep and pale blue
10	 <u>Muscari armeniacum</u> 'Valerie Finnis' — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
15	 <i>Narcissus 'Tête-à-tête'</i> — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
10	 <i>Tulipa 'Little Beauty'</i> — Species tulip	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye

M2(E) — north half total: **17 plants + 70 bulbs**

M2(E) — south half — Main terrace, east parapet — south half (≈2.6m)

1,000mm deep · 700mm high planter · raised level, parapet 1,000mm above FFL

All the height on the east run is gathered here, away from the view corridor: a 1.5–2m informal evergreen block that shelters both the lounge and the dining deck from the east. Escallonia for pink flower from June to September, the *Phillyrea* — the glossy self-shaping Mediterranean evergreen the palette was missing — for structure, *Abelia* to carry it into October, *Coronilla* for the depths of winter. At the back, the oleaster's tiny invisible flowers scent this whole end of the terrace in October — the best salt windbreak there is, reduced once a year from the front like the *Atriplex*. The front ribbon is where the autumn lives — *Hylotelephium*, *Aster* 'Mönch' in lavender-blue — and three *Iris unguicularis* tucked at the sunny foot of it, flowering lilac in November when nothing else is.

Why it is planted this way. All the taller shrub mass on this run is concentrated here, away from the view corridor — a 1.5–2m informal evergreen block giving east wind shelter to the lounge and the dining deck. The parapet holds only the lowest 300mm, so every shrub here is chosen for a mature spread of no more than about 1.6m: enough to sit within the 1,000mm planter without cantilevering far past the coping.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Back row

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u>Escallonia 'Apple Blossom'</u> — Escallonia New	1.5–2.5m x 1.5–2.5m ⁺	Jun–Sep	Informal shrub; occasional reduction from the front only	7.5L
1	 <u>Elaeagnus x ebbingei</u> — Oleaster New	2.5–4m x 2.5–4m ⁺	Oct–Nov	The October scent, and the best salt windbreak there is	7.5L
1	 <u>Atriplex halimus</u> — Tree purslane New	1.5–2.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Summer	⚠ Brightest silver shrub there is — cut hard back every spring	3L

Mid row

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u>Phillyrea angustifolia</u> — Phillyrea New	2.5–4m x 1.5–2.5m ⁺	May–Jun	Glossy, self-shaping evergreen — the palette was missing it	5L
1	 <u>Euphorbia characias subsp. wulfenii</u> — Mediterranean spurge Sussex Sq	1–1.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Feb–May	⚠ Evergreen architecture year-round; sap is an irritant	3–5L
1	 <u>Cistus x purpureus 'Alan Fradd'</u> — Rock rose Springfield Rd	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Spectacular; short-lived, around ten years	3L

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Teucrium fruticans</i> 'Azureum'</u> — Tree germander New	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	May–Sep	Silver-blue evergreen foliage	3L
1	 <u><i>Coronilla valentina</i> subsp. <i>glauca</i></u> 'Citrina' — Yellow coronilla Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Dec–Apr	The winter-flowering shrub, scented at midday	3L
1	 <u><i>Abelia</i> × <i>grandiflora</i></u> — Glossy abelia Springfield Rd	2.5–4m × 2.5–4m ⁺	Jul–Oct	Arching stems; serious pollinator plant	5L

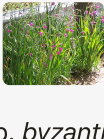
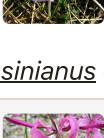
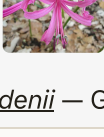
Front ribbon

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
3	 <u><i>Iris unguicularis</i></u> — Algerian iris New	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Nov–Mar	Wants poor soil and a hot dry summer bake	1–2L
3	 <u><i>Aster</i> × <i>frikartii</i> 'Mönch'</u> — Michaelmas daisy Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Aug–Oct	Critical late nectar for butterflies before hibernation	2L

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
3	 <u><i>Eryngium bourgatii</i> 'Picos Blue'</u> — Sea holly Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Jun–Aug	Wind-proof; top-rated for pollinators	1–2L
3	 <u><i>Stachys byzantina</i> 'Big Ears'</u> — Lamb's ears Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Sep	Silver felted mats; wool carder bees strip the hairs	1L
2	 <u><i>Hylotelephium</i> 'Matrona'</u> — Stonecrop / iceplant Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Aug–Oct	Seed heads stand all winter	2L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
25	 <u><i>Allium hollandicum</i> 'Purple Sensation'</u> — Ornamental onion	May, purple drumsticks
10	 <u><i>Allium cristophii</i></u> — Star of Persia	May–Jun
30	 <u><i>Allium sphaerocephalon</i></u> — Drumstick allium	Jul, wine-purple

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <i>Narcissus poeticus</i> var. <i>recurvus</i> — Pheasant's eye	May, white with a red-rimmed eye
15	 <i>Narcissus</i> 'Thalia' — Daffodil	Apr, pure white, 35cm
15	 <i>Narcissus</i> 'Rijnveld's Early Sensation' — Daffodil	January
20	 <i>Tulipa saxatilis</i> (Bakeri Gp) 'Lilac Wonder' — Cretan tulip	Apr, lilac-pink, yellow eye
20	 <i>Gladiolus communis</i> subsp. <i>byzantinus</i> — Byzantine gladiolus	May–Jun, magenta
20	 <i>Crocus tommasinianus</i> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
8	 <i>Nerine bowdenii</i> — Guernsey lily	October, pink

M2(E) — south half total: **23 plants + 183 bulbs**

M2(S) — Main terrace — south return of the SE L

3.5m external / 2.5m internal × **1,000mm deep** · 700mm high · raised level, parapet 1,000mm above FFL

The heritage picture, and the one you look straight at from the dining table: the hero of the five olives — genuinely gnarled, aged-trunk character — rising out of a silver thicket, in the deepest planter on the terrace and outside every protected sightline, so it is allowed real height. Around it, tree purslane at its brightest silver, *Euphorbia*, a *Cistus* opening white-with-a-maroon-blotch in June, silver-blue *Teucrium*, and *Coronilla* flowering pale lemon

through the middle of winter. At the front, Russian sage, a perennial wallflower and blue oat grass carry it from midsummer into autumn, and two *Iris unguicularis* flower at the sunny foot of it in November when nothing else is.

Why it is planted this way. The heritage focal point, seen head-on from the dining table and the lounge, and outside every protected view corridor — so this is where the scheme is allowed real height. The 1m depth also gives the setback that removes the need for fall-protection glass along this edge. This is the one place the character budget is spent: one genuinely gnarled olive, seen head-on from the dining table, rather than four half-gnarled ones nobody looks at closely. The other four olives are ordinary multi-stems — olives gnarl in place; that is what they do.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Back row

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Olea europaea</i></u> — multi-stem, gnarled — Olive Sussex Sq	4–8m x 1.5–2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	The hero — genuinely gnarled, aged-trunk character	45–60L · 1.75–2.0m
1	 <u><i>Atriplex halimus</i></u> — Tree purslane New	1.5–2.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Summer	⚠ Brightest silver shrub there is — cut hard back every spring	3L
1	 <u><i>Euphorbia characias</i></u> subsp. <u><i>wulfenii</i></u> — Mediterranean spurge Sussex Sq	1–1.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Feb–May	⚠ Evergreen architecture year-round; sap is an irritant	3–5L

Mid row

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Cistus x purpureus</i> 'Alan Fradd'</u> — Rock rose Springfield Rd	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Spectacular; short-lived, around ten years	3L
1	 <u><i>Teucrium fruticans</i> 'Azureum'</u> — Tree germander New	1–1.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	May–Sep	Silver-blue evergreen foliage	3L
1	 <u><i>Coronilla valentina</i> subsp. <i>glauca</i> 'Citrina'</u> — Yellow coronilla Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Dec–Apr	The winter-flowering shrub, scented at midday	3L
1	 <u><i>Brachyglottis</i> 'Sunshine'</u> — Dunedin daisy bush Sussex Sq	1–1.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Silver felted evergreen daisy bush	3L
1	 <u><i>Phlomis fruticosa</i></u> — Jerusalem sage Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Felted grey-green year-round, then sculptural seed heads	3L

Front ribbon

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
3	 <u>Salvia yangii</u> 'Little Spire' — Russian sage New	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Aug–Oct	Compact form — the species flops in wind	2L
3	 <u>Erysimum</u> 'Bowles's Mauve' — Perennial wallflower New	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Mar–Nov	Unbeatable first-year value; short-lived (~3 yrs)	2L
3	 <u>Helictotrichon sempervirens</u> — Blue oat grass New	1–1.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer	The wind made visible; comb out dead leaves in spring	2L
2	 <u>Iris unguicularis</u> — Algerian iris New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Nov–Mar	Wants poor soil and a hot dry summer bake	1–2L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u>Allium hollandicum</u> 'Purple Sensation' — Ornamental onion	May, purple drumsticks
5	 <u>Allium cristophii</u> — Star of Persia	May–Jun

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u>Allium sphaerocephalon</u> — Drumstick allium	Jul, wine-purple
15	 <u>Narcissus poeticus</u> var. <u>recurvus</u> — Pheasant's eye	May, white with a red-rimmed eye
15	 <u>Narcissus 'Rijnveld's Early Sensation'</u> — Daffodil	January
15	 <u>Tulipa clusiana 'Lady Jane'</u> — Lady tulip	Apr, white / rose
15	 <u>Gladiolus communis</u> subsp. <u>byzantinus</u> — Byzantine gladiolus	May–Jun, magenta
25	 <u>Crocus tommasinianus</u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
15	 <u>Iris reticulata</u> 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin' — Dwarf iris	Feb, deep and pale blue
7	 <u>Nerine bowdenii</u> — Guernsey lily	October, pink
7	 <u>Nectaroscordum siculum</u> — Sicilian honey garlic	Jun, cream / green / maroon bells

M2(S) total: **19 plants + 159 bulbs**

M4 — Main terrace — north of the lounge seating

2.70m long × 600mm deep · 700mm high planter · parapet here is 1,300mm above FFL

A low green fringe on the north side of the lounge, capped at a metre so the Downs stay visible from the sauna. It grades along its length: a purple 'Tom Thumb' dome, two bright green *Hebe* and a drift of blue oat grass — the wind made visible from the lounge — at the west end where there is room, dropping to prostrate rosemary, sea thrift, cheddar pinks and trailing *Euphorbia myrsinites* at the east end where the sightline is tightest. Two *Hylotelephium* give it an autumn, and *Nerine* comes up pink out of it in October.

Why it is planted this way. Height cap: 1m above the planter rim — 1.7m above finished floor level — and lower at the east end. M4 sits in the view of the Downs from the sauna, so it is graded: domes and grasses to the full 1m at the west end, dropping to mats at the east end where the sightline is tightest. At 1.7m it still does useful work as a north / north-east windbreak for the lounge. Nothing in it is ever pruned beyond the grass comb-out.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

West end — domes to ~1m above the rim

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Tom Thumb'</u> — Purple dwarf kohuhu Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	—	Naturally rounded purple-bronze dome, no pruning ever	5L
2	 <u><i>Hebe (Veronica) 'Rakaiensis'</i></u> — Shrubby veronica Springfield Rd	0.5–1m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Tight bright-green evergreen domes	2L

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
2	 <u><i>Hylotelephium</i> 'Matrona'</u> — Stonecrop / iceplant Sussex Sq	0.5–1m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Aug– Oct	Seed heads stand all winter	2L
3	 <u><i>Helictotrichon sempervirens</i></u> — Blue oat grass New	1–1.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer	The wind made visible; comb out dead leaves in spring	2L

East end — tapering to mats, ~150–300mm

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply
2	 <u><i>Salvia rosmarinus</i> 'Prostratus'</u> — Trailing rosemary Springfield Rd	0.1–0.5m x 1– 1.5m ⁺	Spring– summer	Evergreen, culinary; trails over the planter edges	2L
2	 <u><i>Armeria maritima</i></u> — Sea thrift New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Apr–Jun	UK coastal native; evergreen cushions	9cm– 1L
2	 <u><i>Dianthus gratianopolitanus</i></u> — Cheddar pink New	0.1–0.5m x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	May–Jul	UK native; strongly clove- scented evergreen mats	1L
2	 <u><i>Euphorbia myrsinites</i></u> — Myrtle spurge Sussex Sq	up to 10cm x 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Mar–May	⚠ Trailing succulent; drapes and never needs cutting	1L

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
30	 <i>Crocus tommasinianus</i> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
20	 <i>Muscari armeniacum</i> 'Valerie Finnis' — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue
20	 <i>Iris reticulata</i> 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin' — Dwarf iris	Feb, deep and pale blue
20	 <i>Narcissus</i> 'Tête-à-tête' — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
15	 <i>Tulipa</i> 'Little Beauty' — Species tulip	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye
8	 <i>Nerine bowdenii</i> — Guernsey lily	October, pink

M4 total: **16 plants + 113 bulbs**

M7 — Main terrace — west of the hot tub, between tub and building

2.0m long × 600mm deep · finishes 150mm above the tub rim

Between the tub and the sauna wall, so everything in it gets brushed, steamed and looked at from inside the water. A small **olive** and a **myrtle** for the Mediterranean picture, two bright-green *Hebe* domes, rosemary arching over the edge, and a silver *Convolvulus*. Every one of them is glossy or tight and holds its leaves — chosen specifically so nothing sheds into the water.

Why it is planted this way. Wind defence on the building side of the tub, and everything you brush past getting in and out is aromatic. **Chosen for low leaf and petal drop** — glossy evergreens that hold their leaves, nothing that sheds spent flowers into the water. **The olive here (and the one in M2(E)) stands**

upwind of the tub and will shed some small leaf — the accepted price of standing privacy cover; see §14.
See §16 on the hot tub.

Mulch and feeding: 10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring. Slow-release granular feed each April; **no compost** — see §12.

Back row

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u><i>Olea europaea</i></u> — Olive Sussex Sq	4–8m × 1.5–2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	As above, at a smaller scale	15–25L · 1.2–1.5m
1	 <u><i>Myrtus communis</i> subsp. <i>tarentina</i></u> — Compact myrtle New	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jul–Sep	Naturally dense dome; needs no clipping at all	5L

Front ribbon

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
2	 <u><i>Hebe</i> (<i>Veronica</i>) 'Rakaiensis'</u> — Shrubby veronica Springfield Rd	0.5–1m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Tight bright-green evergreen domes	2L
1	 <u><i>Salvia rosmarinus</i> 'Severn Sea'</u> — Semi-prostrate rosemary Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Feb–May	Flowers when almost nothing else does	2L
1	 <u><i>Convolvulus cneorum</i></u> — Silverbush New	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	May–Sep	The most metallic silver evergreen here	2L

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply
1	 <u>Thymus vulgaris</u> · <u>T. 'Silver Posie'</u> · <u>T. serpyllum</u> — Thyme — 3 forms New	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Early summer	Evergreen culinary mats; bees swarm the flowers	9cm

Bulbs — planted Oct–Nov, threaded between the plants

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
10	 <u>Narcissus 'Thalia'</u> — Daffodil	Apr, pure white, 35cm
20	 <u>Crocus 'Snow Bunting'</u> — Crocus	Feb, white, scented
10	 <u>Muscari armeniacum 'Valerie Finnis'</u> — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue
10	 <u>Tulipa 'Little Beauty'</u> — Species tulip	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye

M7 total: **7 plants + 50 bulbs**

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6. The pots

Five groups, all with an odd number of pots except where sharing makes it even. Specification and material in §7.

Group A — narrow terrace, south end

The five pots by the study door do the winter work. A clipped bay and a bronze *Phormium* for structure, then **Sarcococca** and **Daphne odora** — the two best winter scents in cultivation — placed exactly where you pass them

in the dark in January, with sixty snowdrops and thirty cyclamen underneath. This is the shadiest, most sheltered corner on the terrace, which is the only reason any of it works.

5 pots. The part-shaded corner by the study door, where the winter-scent plants live. Two large, three medium.

Mulch and feeding: no gravel needed — pots are top-dressed with home-made compost each spring. A thin gravel dressing is optional, purely for looks.

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply	Pot
1	 <u>Laurus nobilis</u> — clipped — Bay New	8–12m × wider than 8m ⁺	—	Clipped/potted — treat RHS size as a ceiling, not reality	~80cm, large pot	Ø50–60
1	 <u>Phormium 'Bronze Baby'</u> — Bronze New Zealand flax Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer (rare)	Compact bronze sword foliage — bullet-proof in salt wind	5L	Ø50–60
1	 <u>Sarcococca hookeriana var. humilis</u> — Sweet box / Christmas box Sussex Sq · Springfield Rd	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Winter	The most powerful winter scent of any hardy shrub	3L	Ø40
1	 <u>Daphne odora 'Aureomarginata'</u> — Winter daphne Springfield Rd	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jan–Mar	⚠ Plant once and never move it	3–5L	Ø40

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply	Pot
1	 <u>Convolvulus cneorum</u> — Silverbush New	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	May–Sep	The most metallic silver evergreen here	2L	Ø40 (shared)
1	 <u>Lavandula angustifolia</u> 'Hidcote' — English lavender Springfield Rd	0.1–0.5m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Aug	—	2L	Ø40 (shared)

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
60	 <u>Galanthus nivalis</u> — Snowdrop — buy in the green	Jan–Feb, white
15	 <u>Cyclamen coum</u> — Eastern cyclamen	Jan–Mar, pink / white
10	 <u>Cyclamen hederifolium</u> — Ivy-leaved cyclamen	Sept–Nov, pink / white
10	 <u>Narcissus 'Tête-à-tête'</u> — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
10	 <u>Tulipa clusiana</u> 'Lady Jane' — Lady tulip	Apr, white / rose
10	 <u>Crocus 'Snow Bunting'</u> — Crocus	Feb, white, scented

Group B — narrow terrace, alongside the outdoor kitchen

Six working pots along the kitchen run: three mints in separate pots because they would eat any bed they were put in, parsley, coriander, and chives and sorrel together. Crocus and dwarf daffodils come up through them before the herbs get going, and autumn cyclamen follow when they die back.

6 pots, at the shadier southern end of the kitchen run, which suits every plant in the group. These are the herbs that must not go into a shared bed. Basil is deleted on review advice: salt wind shreds it even in the lee. It lives on the kitchen windowsill instead, and its pot slot goes to coriander.

Mulch and feeding: no gravel needed — pots are top-dressed with home-made compost each spring. A thin gravel dressing is optional, purely for looks. The cyclamen pots come OFF the drip June–August — summer-dormant corms rot under summer water.

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply	Pot
3	 <u><i>Mentha spicata</i></u> · <i>M.</i> 'Moroccan' · <i>M. suaveolens</i> — Mint — 3 kinds New	0.5–1m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Summer	⚠ Never plant into a shared bed — runners take over	2L	Ø40 (each own pot)
3	 <u><i>Petroselinum crispum</i></u> — Flat- leaf parsley New	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Summer (2nd yr)	Biennial — renew annually; wants less sun	1L	Ø30–35 (shared)
3	 <u><i>Coriandrum sativum</i></u> — Coriander New	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Summer– early autumn	⚠ Salt wind shreds it even in the lee — pot only	9cm	Ø30–35 (shared)

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply	Pot
1	 <u>Allium schoenoprasum</u> — Chives New	0.1–0.5m × 0–0.1m ⁺	Jun	Culinary; a genuine bee magnet	1L	Ø30–35 (shared)
1	 <u>Rumex acetosa</u> — Common sorrel New	0.5–1m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Early summer	Hardy perennial salad leaf, sharp and lemony	1L	Ø30–35 (shared)

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u>Crocus tommasinianus</u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
10	 <u>Narcissus 'Tête-à-tête'</u> — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
10	 <u>Cyclamen hederifolium</u> — Ivy-leaved cyclamen	Sept–Nov, pink / white

Group C — main terrace, east of the hot tub — see-through, look-under

Four low pots and one small tree east of the tub. From inside the water you see over and *through* the tops of the aromatics — a fringe of foliage at the rim of the view, never a screen — and you look *under* the olive: it is supplied on a clear stem to about 1.2m, so from tub height its canopy floats above the sightline to the Downs and gives a little dappled cover from above. Set the pots out and check all of it from inside the tub before settling them — that is what movable pots are for.

5 pots, deliberately low so the east view to the Downs from the tub stays open, and deliberately **low-shedding** so nothing drops into the water. All evergreen and all aromatic or tactile when brushed. Movable, so they lift clear for the Phase-2 crane lift.

Mulch and feeding: no gravel needed — pots are top-dressed with home-made compost each spring. A thin gravel dressing is optional, purely for looks.

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply	Pot
1	 <u><i>Olea europaea</i></u> — clear stem — Olive Sussex Sq	4–8m × 1.5–2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Clear stem — looked under, not through, from the tub	20–30L · clear stem to ~1.2m	Ø50– 60
1	 <u><i>Salvia rosmarinus</i></u> 'Prostratus' — Trailing rosemary Springfield Rd	0.1–0.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Spring– summer	Evergreen, culinary; trails over the planter edges	2L	Ø30– 35
1	 <u><i>Thymus vulgaris</i></u> · <i>T.</i> 'Silver Posie' · <i>T. serpyllum</i> — Thyme — 3 forms New	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	Early summer	Evergreen culinary mats; bees swarm the flowers	9cm	Ø30– 35
1	 <u><i>Dianthus gratianopolitanus</i></u> — Cheddar pink New	0.1–0.5m × 0.1–0.5m ⁺	May–Jul	UK native; strongly clove-scented evergreen mats	1L	Ø30– 35
1	 <u><i>Santolina chamaecyparissus</i></u> — Cotton lavender Sussex Sq	0.1–0.5m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer	Shear the buds in June if they jar	2L	Ø40

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u><i>Crocus tommasinianus</i></u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
15	 <i>Iris reticulata</i> 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin' — Dwarf iris	Feb, deep and pale blue
10	 <i>Tulipa</i> 'Little Beauty' — Species tulip	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye
8	 <i>Nerine bowdenii</i> — Guernsey lily	October, pink

Group D — main terrace, south and west of the lounge sofas

Four pots framing the lounge, low enough not to catch the north-east view: two purple 'Tom Thumb' domes, a silver *Convolvulus* and an 'Amethyst Lips' salvia that flowers from May to November. Being movable is the point — set them out and look from the dining table before you commit.

4 pots framing the lounge. Kept low-to-medium because this group sits between the dining deck and the lounge, near the north-east view corridor. The Phase-2 sofa parasol's mast lands just south of the sofas, among this group — set the pots out only after the mast is in, and keep the two 'Tom Thumb' larges clear of the canopy's furled drop zone. **Set them out and check the sightline from the dining table before settling them** — that is what movable pots are for.

Mulch and feeding: no gravel needed — pots are top-dressed with home-made compost each spring. A thin gravel dressing is optional, purely for looks.

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply	Pot
2	 <i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Tom Thumb' — Purple dwarf kohuhu Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	—	Naturally rounded purple-bronze dome, no pruning ever	5L	Ø50–60

Qty	Plant	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Supply	Pot
1	 <u><i>Convolvulus cneorum</i></u> — Silverbush New	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	May– Sep	The most metallic silver evergreen here	2L	Ø40
1	 <u><i>Salvia microphylla</i></u> 'Amethyst Lips' — Shrubby sage Sussex Sq	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Oct	Blackcurrant-scented leaves when brushed	2L	Ø40

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
30	 <u><i>Crocus tommasinianus</i></u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
20	 <u><i>Muscari armeniacum</i></u> 'Valerie Finnis' — Grape hyacinth	Apr, pale powder blue
15	 <u><i>Narcissus</i></u> 'Tête-à-tête' — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
15	 <u><i>Tulipa</i></u> 'Little Beauty' — Species tulip	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye

Group E — the cat's corner, by the study door

Two low pans for the cat, beside the litter store where she already goes. Real catnip in its own pan because she will flatten it, and a tray of cat grass so the ornamental grasses survive. A cat can't reach into a full-height pot; pans sit at her level, and she will lie in them, which is the point. Crocus and cyclamen for us, threaded in the pans and around them.

2 pots, tucked beside the litter store where she already goes, each a low terracotta pan no more than ~15cm high. Nothing here is for us. The thyme she lies on is the N4 mat, an easy jump up — this group no longer needs its own thyme pot.

Mulch and feeding: no gravel needed — pots are top-dressed with home-made compost each spring. A thin gravel dressing is optional, purely for looks.

Qty	Plant	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Supply	Pot
1	 <u><i>Nepeta cataria</i></u> — True catnip New	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer–autumn	For the cat — she will roll on it and flatten it	1L	low pan, Ø35–40cm, ~15cm high
1	 <u><i>Dactylis glomerata</i></u> or oat / barley grass — Cat grass New	—	—	Safe to chew; re-sow twice a year	1L or seed	low pan, Ø35–40cm, ~15cm high

Qty	Bulb	Flowers
20	 <u><i>Crocus tommasinianus</i></u> — Early crocus	Feb, lilac
10	 <u><i>Narcissus</i></u> 'Tête-à-tête' — Dwarf daffodil	Feb–Mar, 15cm
8	 <u><i>Cyclamen hederifolium</i></u> — Ivy-leaved cyclamen	Sept–Nov, pink / white

7. Pots and composter — specification

22 pots in five groups, bought as part of this order.

Size	Qty	Holds
Large — Ø50–60cm	5	The bay, the bronze <i>Phormium</i> , the Group C olive, two 'Tom Thumb' domes
Medium — Ø40cm	9	<i>Sarcococca</i> , <i>Daphne</i> , <i>Convolvulus</i> + lavender (shared), the three mints, santolina, the Group D <i>Convolvulus</i> , 'Amethyst Lips'
Small — Ø30–35cm	6	Parsley, coriander, chives + sorrel (shared), prostrate rosemary, thyme, <i>Dianthus</i>
Low pans — Ø35–40cm, ~15cm high	2	Catnip, cat grass — at cat height

Total 22.

Material — real frost-proof terracotta

Terracotta is the right answer here, and on reflection a better one than the charcoal composite it replaces. It is what has stood on Regency terraces in this town for two hundred years; it warms up beside the buff granite paving instead of fighting it; and silver foliage looks better coming out of warm clay than out of grey. It also ages — which is precisely what stops a group of pots looking styled.

It solves the wind problem rather than creating one. A 50cm terracotta pot weighs 15–25kg empty, so the ballast is built in. Plastic pots blow over on this terrace; terracotta will not.

Benchmark makers (Impruneta, Whichford) run £150–£350+ at the large sizes. Brighton rarely passes –3°C, so good mid-range frost-resistant terracotta (Woodlodge, Villaggio Verde or equivalent, with a stated frost guarantee) is the honest specification for most of the group — with the benchmark tier worth paying for only if a particular pot earns it.

One further idea, which reads as less contrived, not more: buy a proportion reclaimed. Architectural salvage yards carry old terracotta by the pallet. It is often cheaper than new at the larger sizes, and nothing on earth looks less styled than a pot that is genuinely forty years old. Worth doing for two or three of the five large pots.

Shapes may vary within the group. This reverses the usual advice: with a composite pot, repetition is what stops it looking cheap, but with terracotta a mix of classic forms — pots, long toms, bowls — reads as collected over time, which is the effect we are after. One material, three sizes plus the two low pans, shapes as they come.

Deliberately not used:

Ruled out	Why
Plastic and light composites	They blow over here. That is settled by experience, not theory
Powder-coated metal	This project has already had a confirmed C5 powder-coat failure on outdoor furniture at this location

Ruled out	Why
Corten steel	Handsome, but it rust-streaks pale stone and the paving here is a buff granite

Glazed colour, used sparingly, is welcome — muted heritage glazes (soft celadon and sage greens, off-whites) sit happily inside the silver/blue/white palette; it is bright modern glazes that would fight it. The client's existing light-green heritage glazed pot joins the group. One or two glazed pieces among the terracotta reads as collected, which is the effect we're after.

Every pot also needs:

- **Pot feet**, so they drain freely and don't stain or pond on the granite.
- **A dripper**. All 22 are on the irrigation — pots dry out far faster than the planters.
- **Positioning over a pedestal**. The five large pots, filled, are **68–95kg** each — position them over pedestal positions BEFORE filling, rather than mid-tile, exactly as the planters are; they will not move again without two people and a sack truck.

And one composter

A **sealed hot composter, around 100 litres** — HOTBIN Mini 100 (£190 at the time of writing) or equivalent. **Please include it in the quote**. The reasoning is in §16; in short, green waste has to leave this roof through the flat, so reducing it on site matters, and the output feeds N4's shaded band and the pots. It sits in the north-east corner beside Store 4, screened by the store.

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8. The plant list

Photographs link through to the RHS entry. **Where it came from** is the provenance of each choice: **Sussex Square** (28 taxa, found growing in the communal gardens), **Springfield Road** (7, from the previous garden), **New** (28, chosen for this site).

Layer 1 — Specimen trees

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Olea europaea</u> — multi-stem, gnarled Olive Sussex Sq	1	45–60L · 1.75–2.0m	4–8m x 1.5– 2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Evergreen silver-grey. Slow, long-lived, and airy enough to screen without walling off a view. This is the one place the character budget is spent: genuinely gnarled, seen head-on from the dining table.	M2(S)
 <u>Olea europaea</u> — multi-stem Olive Sussex Sq	1	45–60L · 1.75–2.0m	4–8m x 1.5– 2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Evergreen silver-grey. An ordinary (not gnarled) multi-stem, bought for canopy presence at high level — a filter for the diagonal sightline into the hot tub, not a wall. Olives gnarl in place; that is what they do.	M2(E) — north half
 <u>Olea europaea</u> — multi-stem Olive Sussex Sq	1	30–35L · ~1.5m	4–8m x 1.5– 2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Evergreen silver-grey. Deliberately the smaller 30–35L size — a 45–60L rootball doesn't fit a 500mm box, and in this exposure a smaller tree anchors faster and rocks less.	N1(N)
 <u>Pittosporum</u> <u>tenuifolium</u> 'Silver Sheen' Kohuhu Springfield Rd	2	20–30L · 1.75–2.0m · furnished to the base	4–8m x 2.5–4m ⁺	May– Jun	Evergreen; fine silver-green leaves on black twigs. Fast, dense, and it filters wind rather than blocking it. Supply furnished to the base — this one is a windbreak as well as a screen, and lifting its crown would open a gap at exactly the height the wind comes through.	N1(E), M1(W)
 <u>Olea europaea</u> Olive Sussex Sq	1	15–25L · 1.2–1.5m	4–8m x 1.5– 2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	As above, at a smaller scale.	M7

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Olea europaea</u> <u>— clear stem</u> Olive Sussex Sq	1	20–30L · clear stem to ~1.2m	4–8m x 1.5– 2.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Evergreen silver-grey. Supplied on a clear stem to about 1.2m so, from a seated hot tub, its canopy floats above the sightline to the Downs and gives a little dappled cover from above.	Group C

Layer 2 — Evergreen backbone — the permeable windbreak

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Myrtus</u> <u>communis</u> <u>subsp.</u> <u>tarentina</u> Compact myrtle New	4	5L	1–1.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Jul–Sep	A naturally dense 1.2–1.5m dome that needs no clipping at all. Small glossy aromatic leaves, white scented flowers Jul–Sep, black berries for the birds. One of the best self-managing coastal evergreens there is.	N1(E), N1(N), M1(W), M7
 <u>Escallonia</u> <u>'Apple Blossom'</u> Escallonia New	1	7.5L	1.5–2.5m x 1.5– 2.5m ⁺	Jun– Sep	Shell-pink Jun–Sep. Grown here as an informal 1.5–2m shrub, not a clipped hedge — the most compact Escallonia, and it needs only an occasional reduction from the front.	M2(E) — south half
 <u>Atriplex</u> <u>halimus</u> Tree purslane New	2	3L	1.5–2.5m x 1– 1.5m ⁺	Summer	The brightest silver of any hardy shrub; grows on shingle beaches. ⚠ The one fast, lax plant in the scheme — cut hard back every spring from the front. Used only in the 1,000mm-deep planters where there is room for it.	M2(E) — south half, M2(S)

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Phillyrea</u> <u>angustifolia</u> Phillyrea New	2	5L	2.5–4m x 1.5– 2.5m ⁺	May– Jun	Glossy, self-shaping Mediterranean evergreen — narrow willow-like leaves, small white scented flowers in late spring. The naturally shapely structure plant the palette was missing.	N1(E), M2(E) — south half
 <u>Elaeagnus x</u> <u>ebbingei</u> Oleaster New	1	7.5L	2.5–4m x 2.5– 4m ⁺	Oct– Nov	Silvery evergreen; tiny, almost invisible flowers in October and November perfume the whole end of the terrace — the scent the terrace is named for. The best salt windbreak of all. Reduced once a year from the front, like the Atriplex.	M2(E) — south half

Layer 3 — Mediterranean mid-layer

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Pittosporum</u> <u>tenuifolium</u> 'Tom Thumb' Purple dwarf kohuhu Sussex Sq	6	5L	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	—	Naturally rounded 1m dome of deep purple-bronze foliage, no pruning ever. The foliage-colour contrast the scheme was missing, and it stays on the cool palette.	N1(E), M1(W), M4, Group D
 <u>Euphorbia</u> <u>characias</u> subsp. <u>wulfenii</u> Mediterranean spurge Sussex Sq	4	3–5L	1–1.5m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Feb– May	Feb–May chartreuse bracts; evergreen architecture year-round. Sap is an irritant — gloves.	N1(E), M1(W), M2(E) — south half, M2(S)

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Brachyglottis</u> 'Sunshine' Dunedin daisy bush Sussex Sq	3	3L	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Silver felted evergreen; yellow daisies Jun–Jul (shear the buds off if unwanted).	N1(E), M1(W), M2(S)
 <u>Pittosporum</u> tenuifolium 'Golf Ball' Dwarf kohuhu Sussex Sq	2	5L	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	—	Naturally spherical evergreen, clipped to 60–80cm. The repeating rhythm that holds the scheme together in winter.	N1(E), M1(N)
 <u>Cistus x</u> purpureus 'Alan Fradd' Rock rose Springfield Rd	2	3L	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Jul	White with a maroon blotch, Jun–Jul. Spectacular; short-lived (~10 yrs).	M2(E) — south half, M2(S)
 <u>Teucrium</u> fruticans 'Azureum' Tree germander New	2	3L	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	May– Sep	Silver-blue evergreen foliage; deep blue flowers May–Sep.	M2(E) — south half, M2(S)

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Coronilla</u> <u>valentina</u> subsp. <u>glauca</u> 'Citrina' Yellow coronilla Sussex Sq	2	3L	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Dec– Apr	Dec–Apr pale lemon, scented at midday — the winter-flowering shrub.	M2(E) — south half, M2(S)
 <u>Phlomis fruticosa</u> Jerusalem sage Sussex Sq	1	3L	0.5–1m x 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Felted grey-green year-round; yellow whorls Jun–Jul, then sculptural seed heads.	M2(S)
 <u>Abelia</u> x <u>grandiflora</u> Glossy abelia Springfield Rd	1	5L	2.5–4m x 2.5– 4m ⁺	Jul–Oct	Jul–Oct white/blush scented flowers on arching stems. Serious pollinator plant.	M2(E) — south half

Layer 4 — Front ribbon — silver mats, aromatics and long-flowering perennials

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Lavandula</u> <u>angustifolia</u> <u>'Hidcote'</u> English lavender Springfield Rd	16	2L	0.1–0.5m × 0.5– 1m ⁺	Jun–Aug	Deep purple, Jun–Aug.	N1(E), N2, N4, M1(W), Group A
 <u>Stachys byzantina</u> <u>'Big Ears'</u> Lamb's ears Sussex Sq	9	1L	0.1–0.5m × 0.5– 1m ⁺	Jun–Sep	Silver felted mats year-round. Wool carder bees strip the leaf hairs to line their nests.	N1(E), M1(W), M2(E) — south half
 <u>Erigeron</u> <u>karvinskianus</u> Mexican fleabane Sussex Sq	2	1L	0.1–0.5m × 0.5– 1m ⁺	Apr–Nov	Apr–Nov — nine months of tiny white-to-pink daisies. Self-seeds into paving joints.	N1(E)

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Hebe (Veronica)</u> <u>'Rakaiensis'</u> Shrubby veronica Springfield Rd	4	2L	0.5–1m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jun–Jul	Tight bright-green evergreen domes; white spikes Jun–Jul.	M4, M7
 <u>Armeria maritima</u> Sea thrift New	10	9cm– 1L	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Apr–Jun	UK coastal native. Pink pompoms Apr–Jun over evergreen cushions.	N1(N), M2(E) — north half, M4
 <u>Festuca glauca</u> <u>'Elijah Blue'</u> Blue fescue Sussex Sq	7	1L	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Late spring– summer	Blue-grey evergreen tussock — texture at the front all year.	N1(N), N2, M2(E) — north half
 <u>Dianthus</u> <u>gratianopolitanus</u> Cheddar pink New	6	1L	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	May–Jul	UK native. Evergreen grey mats; strongly clove-scented May–Jul.	M2(E) — north half, M4, Group C

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Salvia microphylla</u> <u>'Amethyst Lips'</u> Shrubby sage Sussex Sq	3	2L	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Jun–Oct	May–Nov purple-and-white; blackcurrant-scented leaves when brushed.	N4, Group D
 <u>Hylotelephium</u> <u>'Matrona'</u> Stonecrop / iceplant Sussex Sq	7	2L	0.5–1m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Aug–Oct	Aug–Oct dusky pink on purple stems, then seed heads standing all winter.	N2, M1(W), M2(E) — south half, M4
 <u>Iris unguicularis</u> Algerian iris New	5	1–2L	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Nov–Mar	Nov–March lilac-blue, scented. Demands exactly this: poor, sharply drained soil with a hot dry summer bake.	M2(E) — south half, M2(S)
 <u>Euphorbia</u> <u>myrsinites</u> Myrtle spurge Sussex Sq	5	1L	up to 10cm × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Mar–May	Trailing blue-grey succulent whorls, only 15cm high, with chartreuse bracts Mar–May. Drapes over a rim and never needs cutting. Sap is an irritant.	M2(E) — north half, M4

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Nepeta x faassenii</u> <u>'Walker's Low'</u> Catmint Sussex Sq	9	1-2L	0.1-0.5m x 0.1- 0.5m ⁺	Jun-Sep	Blue haze Jun-Sep if sheared after the first flush.	N1(E), M1(W), M1(N)
 <u>Convolvulus</u> <u>cneorum</u> Silverbush New	3	2L	0.5-1m x 0.5-1m ⁺	May-Sep	The most metallic silver evergreen here; white trumpets May-Sep.	M7, Group A, Group D
 <u>Santolina</u> <u>chamaecyparissus</u> Cotton lavender Sussex Sq	3	2L	0.1-0.5m x 0.5- 1m ⁺	Summer	Tight silver dome. Shear the buds in June if the yellow buttons jar; sheared, it drops nothing into the tub.	N4, Group C
 <u>Salvia rosmarinus</u> <u>'Severn Sea'</u> Semi-prostrate rosemary Sussex Sq	4	2L	0.5-1m x 0.5-1m ⁺	Feb-May	Feb-May vivid blue — flowers when almost nothing else does. Arches over the rim.	N1(E), M7

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Salvia nemorosa</u> <u>'Caradonna'</u> Balkan clary Sussex Sq	3	1–2L	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	May–Jul	Violet spikes on black stems, May–Jul — the sharpest contrast against silver foliage.	M1(W)
 <u>Eryngium bourgatii</u> <u>'Picos Blue'</u> Sea holly Sussex Sq	3	1–2L	0.5–1m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Jun–Aug	Steel-blue thistle heads Jun–Aug over silver-veined leaves. Wind-proof; top-rated for pollinators.	M2(E) — south half
 <u>Crithmum</u> <u>maritimum</u> Rock samphire New	2	1L	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Apr–Sep	UK shingle-shore native, found on the Sussex coast. Succulent blue-green; edible. Sited at the driest edge — a shingle plant that flops in fed compost; an experiment worth two plants.	M2(E) — north half
 <u>Aster × frikartii</u> <u>'Mönch'</u> Michaelmas daisy Sussex Sq	3	2L	0.5–1m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Aug–Oct	Aug–Oct lavender-blue — critical late nectar for butterflies before hibernation.	M2(E) — south half

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Salvia yangii</u> 'Little Spire' Russian sage New	3	2L	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Aug–Oct	Aug–Oct blue haze on silver stems. The compact form — the species flops in wind.	M2(S)
 <u>Erysimum</u> 'Bowles's Mauve' Perennial wallflower New	3	2L	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Mar–Nov	Mar–Nov, almost continuously. Unbeatable first-year value; short-lived (~3 yrs).	M2(S)
 <u>Helictotrichon sempervirens</u> Blue oat grass New	9	2L	1–1.5m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer	Blue-grey evergreen tussock grass, taller and more architectural than the fescues — oat-like flower plumes catch the wind all summer. “The wind made visible”, from the lounge and the dining table alike. Comb out dead leaves in spring.	N1(E), M2(S), M4

Layer 5 — Culinary herbs, and the cat's pots

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Thymus vulgaris</u> · <u>T. 'Silver Posie'</u> · <u>T. serpyllum</u> Thyme — 3 forms New	12	9cm	0.1–0.5m x 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Early summer	Evergreen culinary mats; bees swarm the flowers.	N3, N4, M7, Group C
 <u>Salvia rosmarinus</u> <u>'Prostratus'</u> Trailing rosemary Springfield Rd	8	2L	0.1–0.5m x 1– 1.5m ⁺	Spring– summer	Evergreen, culinary; trails over the planter edges.	N4, M4, Group C
 <u>Salvia rosmarinus</u> <u>'Miss Jessopp's</u> <u>Upright'</u> Upright rosemary Sussex Sq	4	2L	1.5–2.5m x 1– 1.5m ⁺	Feb–May	Evergreen, culinary; blue flowers Feb–May.	N3, N4
 <u>Origanum</u> <u>'Herrenhausen'</u> Ornamental marjoram New	4	1L	0.1–0.5m x 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Jul–Sep	Purple bracts Jul–Sep — one of the highest-rated butterfly plants there is.	N3, N4

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Allium</u> <u>schoenoprasum</u> Chives New	3	1L	0.1–0.5m × 0– 0.1m ⁺	Jun	Culinary; mauve pompoms in June are a genuine bee magnet.	N4, Group B
 <u>Mentha spicata</u> · <u>M. 'Moroccan'</u> · <u>M.</u> <u>suaveolens</u> Mint — 3 kinds New	3	2L	0.5–1m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Summer	Garden mint for cooking, Moroccan for tea, apple mint. Never plant mint into a shared bed — the runners take the whole thing in one season. Wants more water than everything else, so give its pots their own dripper.	Group B
 <u>Petroselinum</u> <u>crispum</u> Flat-leaf parsley New	3	1L	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Summer (2nd yr)	Biennial — renew annually. Wants more water and less sun than the Mediterranean herbs, so keep it potted in the part-shaded south end.	Group B
 <u>Coriandrum</u> <u>sativum</u> Coriander New	3	9cm	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Summer– early autumn	Culinary. Basil's replacement in the pot run — salt wind shreds it even in the lee, so coriander (tougher, and just as useful in the kitchen) takes the slot instead.	Group B

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H x S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Phormium 'Bronze Baby'</u> Bronze New Zealand flax Sussex Sq	2	5L	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer (rare)	Bronze evergreen sword foliage — architecture, and bullet-proof in salt wind. The compact bronze form; the full <i>P. tenax</i> would swallow this square in four years.	N2, Group A
 <u>Origanum vulgare</u> Wild marjoram / oregano Sussex Sq	2	1L	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Jul–Sep	UK native. The cooking oregano.	N4
 <u>Salvia officinalis</u> Common sage New	2	2L	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Early summer	Evergreen grey-green; the cooking sage.	N4
 <u>Salvia officinalis 'Purpurascens'</u> Purple sage New	2	2L	0.5–1m x 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer	Culinary, and the purple foliage sits on the cool palette.	N3

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Satureja montana</u> Winter savory New	2	1L	0.1–0.5m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Summer	Evergreen Mediterranean herb — pepperiness for beans and stews. Underused and very tough.	N4
 <u>Artemisia dracunculus</u> French tarragon New	2	1L	0.5–1m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Late summer	Culinary. Must be French, not Russian — Russian tarragon is near-flavourless.	N4
 <u>Rumex acetosa</u> Common sorrel New	2	1L	0.5–1m × 0.1– 0.5m ⁺	Early summer	Hardy perennial salad leaf, sharp and lemony. Happy in the part shade at the south end.	N4, Group B
 <u>Laurus nobilis — clipped</u> Bay New	1	~80cm, large pot	8–12m × wider than 8m ⁺	—	Evergreen, dark, on-palette, and a kitchen staple. Shade-tolerant, evergreen and on-palette — moved here from Group B; the olive that occupied this spot needs sun and has moved to Group C.	Group A

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Nepeta cataria</u> True catnip New	1	1L	0.5–1m × 0.5–1m ⁺	Summer– autumn	For the cat. The real thing, far stronger than the ornamental catmints. Give it its own pot — she will roll on it and flatten it, and it recovers.	Group E
 <u>Dactylis glomerata</u> or oat / barley grass Cat grass New	1	1L or seed	—	—	For the cat. Safe to chew, and it saves the ornamental grasses from being nibbled. Re-sow twice a year.	Group E

Layer 6 — Winter scent for the part-shaded south end

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Sarcococca</u> <u>hookeriana</u> var. <u>humilis</u> Sweet box / Christmas box Sussex Sq · Springfield Rd	2	3L	0.5–1m × 0.5– 1m ⁺	Winter	Dec–Feb: the most powerful winter scent of any hardy shrub, from flowers you can barely see. Evergreen, low, suckering. Needs the part shade at the south end.	N4, Group A
 <u>Daphne odora</u> <u>'Aureomarginata'</u> Winter daphne Springfield Rd	1	3–5L	1–1.5m × 1–1.5m ⁺	Jan– Mar	Jan–Mar, pink-flushed white, gloriously scented; cream-edged evergreen leaves. From your old garden — the part-shaded south end is the one place here it stands a chance. Plant once and never move it.	Group A

Plant	Total	Supply	Mature H × S	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Helleborus argutifolius</u> Corsican hellebore Sussex Sq	1	2L	0.5–1m × 0.5– 1m [†]	Feb– Apr	Feb–Apr apple-green cups over architectural spiny evergreen leaves. Early nectar for waking bumblebees; tolerates dry part shade.	N4

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9. Bulbs and corms

Planted **October–November**, threaded between the shrubs and through the front ribbon — except the snowdrops, which we'd like **in the green**, delivered February–March.

Bulb / corm	Total	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Crocus tommasinianus</u> Early crocus New	350	Feb, lilac	Naturalises freely in hot, sharply drained conditions	N1(E), N1(N), N2, N4, M1(W), M1(N), M2(E) — north half, M2(E) — south half, M2(S), M4, Group B, Group C, Group D, Group E

Bulb / corm	Total	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Narcissus 'Tête-à-tête'</u> Dwarf daffodil New	160	Feb–Mar, 15cm	The wind-proof early daffodil	N1(E), N1(N), N2, N4, M1(N), M2(E) — north half, M4, Group A, Group B, Group D, Group E
 <u>Iris reticulata</u> <u>'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin'</u> Dwarf iris New	150	Feb, deep and pale blue	Wants a hot dry summer bake	N1(E), N2, N3, N4, M2(E) — north half, M2(S), M4, Group C
 <u>Muscari armeniacum</u> <u>'Valerie Finnis'</u> Grape hyacinth New	150	Apr, pale powder blue		N1(E), N1(N), N4, M1(W), M1(N), M2(E) — north half, M4, M7, Group D

Bulb / corm	Total	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Allium</u> <u>sphaerocephalon</u> Drumstick allium New	120	Jul, wine-purple	Flowers in the summer gap; wind-proof and inexpensive	N1(E), N3, N4, M2(E) — south half, M2(S)
 <u>Allium hollandicum</u> <u>'Purple Sensation'</u> Ornamental onion Springfield Rd	100	May, purple drumsticks	Plant in drifts of 10–15	N1(E), N1(N), M1(W), M2(E) — south half, M2(S)
 <u>Galanthus nivalis</u> Snowdrop — buy in the green Springfield Rd	100	Jan–Feb, white	⚠ Confined to the part-shaded south end — buy in the green	N4, Group A

Bulb / corm	Total	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Tulipa 'Little Beauty'</u> Species tulip New	90	Apr, 15cm, magenta with a blue eye	Tiny, tough, and a jewel close up	N2, N3, N4, M2(E) — north half, M4, M7, Group C, Group D
 <u>Crocus 'Snow Bunting'</u> Crocus New	90	Feb, white, scented	The white February flower snowdrops can't do in sunny beds	N3, N4, M7, Group A
 <u>Tulipa clusiana 'Lady Jane'</u> Lady tulip Springfield Rd	70	Apr, white / rose	A species tulip — comes back every year, short enough not to snap	N1(E), N4, M1(W), M2(S), Group A
 <u>Narcissus 'Thalia'</u> Daffodil New	60	Apr, pure white, 35cm	The on-palette daffodil	N1(E), M1(W), M2(E) — south half, M7

Bulb / corm	Total	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Tulipa saxatilis (Bakeri Gp) 'Lilac Wonder'</u> Cretan tulip New	60	Apr, lilac-pink, yellow eye	Also perennialises; one of the best tulips for containers	N1(E), N1(N), N4, M2(E) — south half
 <u>Gladiolus communis subsp. byzantinus</u> Byzantine gladiolus Springfield Rd	50	May–Jun, magenta	Thrives on dry sunny neglect and naturalises	N1(E), M2(E) — south half, M2(S)
 <u>Narcissus poeticus var. recurvus</u> Pheasant's eye Springfield Rd	50	May, white with a red-rimmed eye	Scented, and the last daffodil of the season	M1(W), M2(E) — south half, M2(S)

Bulb / corm	Total	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Narcissus 'Rijnveld's Early Sensation'</u> Daffodil New	40	January	A genuine January trumpet daffodil, widely available and inexpensive	N1(E), M2(E) — south half, M2(S)
 <u>Cyclamen hederifolium</u> Ivy-leaved cyclamen New	38	Sept–Nov, pink / white	Flowers before the leaves, then marbled foliage all winter	N4, Group A, Group B, Group E
 <u>Nerine bowdenii</u> Guernsey lily New	37	October, pink	The only October flower in the scheme	N2, M2(E) — south half, M2(S), M4, Group C
 <u>Allium cristophii</u> Star of Persia Springfield Rd	30	May–Jun	The best seed head of any allium — stands until Christmas	N2, M1(W), M2(E) — south half, M2(S)

Bulb / corm	Total	Flowers	Note	Goes in
 <u>Cyclamen coum</u> Eastern cyclamen New	30	Jan–Mar, pink / white	A dry-shade specialist with summer dormancy	N4, Group A
 <u>Nectaroscordum siculum</u> Sicilian honey garlic New	20	Jun, cream / green / maroon bells	Subtle, and superb seed heads	N1(E), M1(W), M2(S)

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10. Year-round interest — checked

Every planter and pot group was audited against five tests: something happening in each of the four seasons, plus evergreen structure to hold it together when nothing is flowering. **All seventeen pass.**

Planter / pot group	Winter	Spring	Summer	Autumn	Evergreen structure	Carries the winter
N1(E)	●	●	●	●	●	rosemary, crocus, seed heads
N1(N)	●	●	●	●	●	olive, myrtle, crocus
N2	●	●	●	●	●	Phormium, fescue, stonecrop heads
N3	●	●	●	●	●	rosemary, sage, thyme — all evergreen
N4	●	●	●	●	●	<i>Sarcococca</i> , hellebore, snowdrops, cyclamen
M1(W)	●	●	●	●	●	<i>Euphorbia</i> , myrtle, 'Tom Thumb'
M1(N)	●	●	●	●	●	'Golf Ball' dome, crocus
M2(E) — north half	●	●	●	●	●	olive, shingle-bank mats, dwarf iris

Planter / pot group	Winter	Spring	Summer	Autumn	Evergreen structure	Carries the winter
M2(E) — south half	●	●	●	●	●	<i>Coronilla</i> , <i>Iris unguicularis</i> , seed heads
M2(S)	●	●	●	●	●	olive, <i>Coronilla</i> , tree purslane
M4	●	●	●	●	●	'Tom Thumb', <i>Hebe</i> , stonecrop heads
M7	●	●	●	●	●	myrtle, <i>Hebe</i> , olive
Group A	●	●	●	●	●	bay, <i>Sarcococca</i> , <i>Daphne</i> , snowdrops
Group B	●	●	●	●	●	parsley overwinters, crocus, cyclamen foliage
Group C	●	●	●	●	●	santolina, olive, dwarf iris
Group D	●	●	●	●	●	'Tom Thumb' domes, crocus
Group E	●	●	●	●	●	cyclamen foliage, crocus

The winter column is the one that matters, because that is where roof planting usually fails. Nothing here relies on a single plant for it: there is evergreen structure in every bed, and the December-to-February interest is spread across scented *Sarcococca* and *Daphne*, *Coronilla* in pale lemon, *Iris unguicularis*, rosemary already in blue flower, standing seed heads, and roughly four hundred crocus.

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11. Schedule of quantities

220 plants and 1,795 bulbs / corms. Supply sizes are what we think is right — please tell us if you'd supply differently.

Plant	Where from	Total	Supply size
Layer 1 — Specimen trees			
<i>Olea europaea</i> — multi-stem, gnarled — Olive	Sussex Sq	1	45–60L · 1.75–2.0m
<i>Olea europaea</i> — multi-stem — Olive	Sussex Sq	1	45–60L · 1.75–2.0m
<i>Olea europaea</i> — multi-stem — Olive	Sussex Sq	1	30–35L · ~1.5m
<i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Silver Sheen' — Kohuhu	Springfield Rd	2	20–30L · 1.75–2.0m · furnished to the base
<i>Olea europaea</i> — Olive	Sussex Sq	1	15–25L · 1.2–1.5m
<i>Olea europaea</i> — clear stem — Olive	Sussex Sq	1	20–30L · clear stem to ~1.2m

Plant	Where from	Total	Supply size
Layer 2 — Evergreen backbone — the permeable windbreak			
<i>Myrtus communis</i> subsp. <i>tarentina</i> — Compact myrtle	New	4	5L
<i>Escallonia</i> 'Apple Blossom' — Escallonia	New	1	7.5L
<i>Atriplex halimus</i> — Tree purslane	New	2	3L
<i>Phillyrea angustifolia</i> — Phillyrea	New	2	5L
<i>Elaeagnus</i> × <i>ebbingei</i> — Oleaster	New	1	7.5L
Layer 3 — Mediterranean mid-layer			
<i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Tom Thumb' — Purple dwarf kohuhu	Sussex Sq	6	5L
<i>Euphorbia characias</i> subsp. <i>wulfenii</i> — Mediterranean spurge	Sussex Sq	4	3–5L
<i>Brachyglottis</i> 'Sunshine' — Dunedin daisy bush	Sussex Sq	3	3L
<i>Pittosporum tenuifolium</i> 'Golf Ball' — Dwarf kohuhu	Sussex Sq	2	5L
<i>Cistus</i> × <i>purpureus</i> 'Alan Fradd' — Rock rose	Springfield Rd	2	3L
<i>Teucrium fruticans</i> 'Azureum' — Tree germander	New	2	3L
<i>Coronilla valentina</i> subsp. <i>glauca</i> 'Citrina' — Yellow coronilla	Sussex Sq	2	3L
<i>Phlomis fruticosa</i> — Jerusalem sage	Sussex Sq	1	3L
<i>Abelia</i> × <i>grandiflora</i> — Glossy abelia	Springfield Rd	1	5L
Layer 4 — Front ribbon — silver mats, aromatics and long-flowering perennials			
<i>Lavandula angustifolia</i> 'Hidcote' — English lavender	Springfield Rd	16	2L
<i>Stachys byzantina</i> 'Big Ears' — Lamb's ears	Sussex Sq	9	1L
<i>Erigeron karvinskianus</i> — Mexican fleabane	Sussex Sq	2	1L
<i>Hebe</i> (Veronica) 'Rakaiensis' — Shrubby veronica	Springfield Rd	4	2L
<i>Armeria maritima</i> — Sea thrift	New	10	9cm–1L
<i>Festuca glauca</i> 'Elijah Blue' — Blue fescue	Sussex Sq	7	1L
<i>Dianthus gratianopolitanus</i> — Cheddar pink	New	6	1L
<i>Salvia microphylla</i> 'Amethyst Lips' — Shrubby sage	Sussex Sq	3	2L
<i>Hylotelephium</i> 'Matrona' — Stonecrop / iceplant	Sussex Sq	7	2L
<i>Iris unguicularis</i> — Algerian iris	New	5	1–2L
<i>Euphorbia myrsinites</i> — Myrtle spurge	Sussex Sq	5	1L
<i>Nepeta</i> × <i>faassenii</i> 'Walker's Low' — Catmint	Sussex Sq	9	1–2L

Plant	Where from	Total	Supply size
<i>Convolvulus cneorum</i> — Silverbush	New	3	2L
<i>Santolina chamaecyparissus</i> — Cotton lavender	Sussex Sq	3	2L
<i>Salvia rosmarinus</i> 'Severn Sea' — Semi-prostrate rosemary	Sussex Sq	4	2L
<i>Salvia nemorosa</i> 'Caradonna' — Balkan clary	Sussex Sq	3	1–2L
<i>Eryngium bourgatii</i> 'Picos Blue' — Sea holly	Sussex Sq	3	1–2L
<i>Crithmum maritimum</i> — Rock samphire	New	2	1L
<i>Aster</i> × <i>frikartii</i> 'Mönch' — Michaelmas daisy	Sussex Sq	3	2L
<i>Salvia yangii</i> 'Little Spire' — Russian sage	New	3	2L
<i>Erysimum</i> 'Bowles's Mauve' — Perennial wallflower	New	3	2L
<i>Helictotrichon sempervirens</i> — Blue oat grass	New	9	2L
Layer 5 — Culinary herbs, and the cat's pots			
<i>Thymus vulgaris</i> · <i>T.</i> 'Silver Posie' · <i>T. serpyllum</i> — Thyme — 3 forms	New	12	9cm
<i>Salvia rosmarinus</i> 'Prostratus' — Trailing rosemary	Springfield Rd	8	2L
<i>Salvia rosmarinus</i> 'Miss Jessopp's Upright' — Upright rosemary	Sussex Sq	4	2L
<i>Origanum</i> 'Herrenhausen' — Ornamental marjoram	New	4	1L
<i>Allium schoenoprasum</i> — Chives	New	3	1L
<i>Mentha spicata</i> · <i>M.</i> 'Moroccan' · <i>M. suaveolens</i> — Mint — 3 kinds	New	3	2L
<i>Petroselinum crispum</i> — Flat-leaf parsley	New	3	1L
<i>Coriandrum sativum</i> — Coriander	New	3	9cm
<i>Phormium</i> 'Bronze Baby' — Bronze New Zealand flax	Sussex Sq	2	5L
<i>Origanum vulgare</i> — Wild marjoram / oregano	Sussex Sq	2	1L
<i>Salvia officinalis</i> — Common sage	New	2	2L
<i>Salvia officinalis</i> 'Purpurascens' — Purple sage	New	2	2L
<i>Satureja montana</i> — Winter savory	New	2	1L
<i>Artemisia dracunculus</i> — French tarragon	New	2	1L
<i>Rumex acetosa</i> — Common sorrel	New	2	1L
<i>Laurus nobilis</i> — clipped — Bay	New	1	~80cm, large pot
<i>Nepeta cataria</i> — True catnip	New	1	1L
<i>Dactylis glomerata</i> or oat / barley grass — Cat grass	New	1	1L or seed

Plant	Where from	Total	Supply size
Layer 6 — Winter scent for the part-shaded south end			
<i>Sarcococca hookeriana</i> var. <i>humilis</i> — Sweet box / Christmas box	Sussex Sq · Springfield Rd	2	3L
<i>Daphne odora</i> 'Aureomarginata' — Winter daphne	Springfield Rd	1	3–5L
<i>Helleborus argutifolius</i> — Corsican hellebore	Sussex Sq	1	2L
Bulbs and corms — dry for Oct–Nov planting, except snowdrops (in the green, Feb–Mar)			
<i>Crocus tommasinianus</i> — Early crocus	New	350	top size
<i>Narcissus</i> 'Tête-à-tête' — Dwarf daffodil	New	160	top size
<i>Iris reticulata</i> 'Harmony' + 'Katharine Hodgkin' — Dwarf iris	New	150	top size
<i>Muscari armeniacum</i> 'Valerie Finnis' — Grape hyacinth	New	150	top size
<i>Allium sphaerocephalon</i> — Drumstick allium	New	120	top size
<i>Allium hollandicum</i> 'Purple Sensation' — Ornamental onion	Springfield Rd	100	top size
<i>Galanthus nivalis</i> — Snowdrop — buy in the green	Springfield Rd	100	top size
<i>Tulipa</i> 'Little Beauty' — Species tulip	New	90	top size
<i>Crocus</i> 'Snow Bunting' — Crocus	New	90	top size
<i>Tulipa clusiana</i> 'Lady Jane' — Lady tulip	Springfield Rd	70	top size
<i>Narcissus</i> 'Thalia' — Daffodil	New	60	top size
<i>Tulipa saxatilis</i> (Bakeri Gp) 'Lilac Wonder' — Cretan tulip	New	60	top size
<i>Gladiolus communis</i> subsp. <i>byzantinus</i> — Byzantine gladiolus	Springfield Rd	50	top size
<i>Narcissus poeticus</i> var. <i>recurvus</i> — Pheasant's eye	Springfield Rd	50	top size
<i>Narcissus</i> 'Rijnveld's Early Sensation' — Daffodil	New	40	top size
<i>Cyclamen hederifolium</i> — Ivy-leaved cyclamen	New	38	top size
<i>Nerine bowdenii</i> — Guernsey lily	New	37	top size
<i>Allium cristophii</i> — Star of Persia	Springfield Rd	30	top size
<i>Cyclamen coum</i> — Eastern cyclamen	New	30	top size
<i>Nectaroscordum siculum</i> — Sicilian honey garlic	New	20	top size

Hard goods — please price these alongside the plants

Item	Qty	Specification
Pot — large, Ø50–60cm	5	Frost-proof terracotta (\$7)

Item	Qty	Specification
Pot — medium, Ø40cm	9	As above
Pot — small, Ø30–35cm	6	As above
Pot — low pan, Ø35–40cm, ~15cm high	2	As above
Pot feet	22 sets	So the pots drain freely and don't stain the granite
Gravel mulch, 10mm	~0.18 m ³ / ~0.3 t (1 bulk bag)	Collars-only finish — see §12
Shade netting, 50%, + fixings	~20m	First winter and first spring — see §15
Hot composter, ~100 litres	1	HOTBIN Mini 100 or equivalent sealed hot bin
Slow-release fertiliser, 6-month	~5 kg	Scattered each April
Rootball anchor kits	7	Platipus RootBall Fixing or equivalent, for the specimens (§15)

Supply notes

- **Peat-free** throughout, please.
- The **olives** should be **multi-stem**, not tall single-trunk standards — that trunk is the visual signature of the Sussex Square plantings and what the heritage argument in the planning application leans on. **Only the M2(S) olive** should be the gnarled/aged-character tier — please price that one tree accordingly. The other four olives are ordinary multi-stems at the sizes given; they will gnarl in place. **The Group C pot olive** needs a clear stem to about 1.2m — it is looked under, from a seated hot tub.
- The two ***Pittosporum* 'Silver Sheen'** must be **furnished to the base — not crown-lifted**. They are windbreaks as well as screens, and lifting their crowns would open a gap at exactly the height the wind comes through.
- **No hedging plants and no clipped forms**, other than the two clipped domes ('Golf Ball' and the bay) which are supplied pre-shaped. Everything else must hold its own shape — see §2.
- **Species tulips must not be substituted for garden hybrids.** *T. clusiana*, *T. saxatilis* and 'Little Beauty' are specified because they are short enough to survive a roof gale and because they perennialise. A 55cm Darwin or Triumph tulip would be an annual here, and would snap.
- **French tarragon, not Russian. No lilies anywhere** — see §17.
- A **10–15% contingency** on the perennial counts is assumed separately for replacements and year-two gap-filling.

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12. Mulch and feeding

We propose **10mm washed gravel** rather than bark. Bark blows off a roof, and it holds moisture against the crowns of silver-leaved Mediterranean plants over a wet winter, which is the commonest way of losing them.

The rule, in one table

Every planter section repeats its own line, but this is the whole policy:

Where	Mulch	Fed with
All twelve planter runs — N1(E), N1(N), N2, N3, M1(W), M1(N), both halves of M2(E), M2(S), M4, M7, and the sunny two-thirds of N4	10mm gravel collar, ~300mm ring round each silver sub-shrub	Slow-release granular fertiliser, April only. No compost, ever
N4's shaded south band — the <i>Sarcococca</i> , hellebore, snowdrops and cyclamen	No gravel. A leafy, open finish	Home-made compost, top-dressed each spring
All 22 pots	No gravel needed. A thin gravel dressing is optional, purely for looks	Home-made compost each spring , plus a liquid feed through summer for the herbs

So: **gravel everywhere the planting is Mediterranean and never gets compost; no gravel in the four places that do get compost.** That is the entire rule.

Why that isn't a fudge

The obvious objection is that if you top-dress with compost every year, the gravel just gets buried. It would — which is why the gravel beds are never top-dressed. Resolving it means separating two jobs that usually get lumped together as "feeding":

Job	How it's done here	Effect on the gravel
Replacing nutrients	Slow-release granular feed, scattered each April	None. It falls straight through the gravel and works down
Replacing organic matter and bulk	Compost top-dressing	Would bury it — so it isn't done on gravel beds

And bulk compost is the wrong thing for this planting anyway. Mediterranean sub-shrubs grown lean and sharply drained are longer-lived, tougher and more wind-firm; rich compost makes them soft, sappy and floppy, which is exactly what salt wind destroys. Beth Chatto's gravel garden is famously neither fed nor watered.

The compost therefore goes where it is genuinely wanted — N4's shaded band and the 22 pots, both of which are cropped or watered hard and neither of which has a gravel finish. On rough numbers the demand there is around 140 litres a year against 40–70 from a 100-litre hot bin, so there is no surplus looking for somewhere to go.

If a gravel collar ever does need topping up — container soil slumps over the years — rake it aside with a hand fork, add, and rake it back. It doesn't vanish. Expect to top the gravel up with a bag or two every three to five years.

Coverage — decided: gravel collars, not a full finish

A ~300mm gravel ring around each silver sub-shrub delivers essentially all of the crown-protection benefit for about a quarter of the weight (~0.3t against 1.1t — one bulk bag instead of two, and no 44-bag haul if it misses a crane).

And collars change the colour logic. Under a full finish the gravel was a visible field, chosen to flatter the paving and the silver foliage. As collars it is a functional detail that should *disappear*: mostly hidden once the plants knit, seen only as rings against dark soil until then. So the recessive colours are now the right ones — **10mm Golden Flint** (the local, coastal choice, grey-brown like the soil) or **Dove Grey**, and NOT the cream Cotswold or black basalt, which would read as polka-dots on the bare soil. Samples still worth £8 each, but the stakes are lower now.

Option	Character	See it
10mm Golden Flint — recommended for collars	Rounded grey-brown flint — the local, coastal option	Long Rake Spar — Golden Flint
10mm Dove Grey — recommended for collars	Softer mid-grey limestone — quieter than the granite	Mainland Aggregates — 10mm Dove Grey
10–20mm Cotswold — full-finish colour, no longer applicable	Warm cream / honey	Long Rake Spar — Cotswold
10mm Silver Granite	Cool grey, angular, crisp	Mainland Aggregates — 10mm Silver Granite
10mm Black Basalt — full-finish colour, no longer applicable	Dark charcoal	Long Rake Spar — Black Basalt

(Weight note for the structural engineer: collars add only ~11 kg/m² averaged over the planter footprints; the builder is still instructed to set finished soil 25mm low so the finish tops out weight-neutral (see the Phase-1 variations).)

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13. Irrigation

Automatic drip irrigation is being installed and ordered by the client (HydroSure components), now on **three zones** from a four-outlet timer at the tap:

Zone 1 — the Mediterranean beds: pressure-compensating dripline, infrequent and deep.

Zone 2 — the ornamental pots and all newly planted specimens for their first two years: moderate.

Zone 3 — the thirsty herbs: the mints, parsley and coriander pots and N4's picking band — frequent. Splitting these off Zone 2 is what stops the terracotta ornamentals being watered like mint.

Two exceptions ride on top: the **cyclamen** pots and patches come off the drip June–August (summer-dormant corms rot under summer water), and the *Crithmum* corner gets the driest end of its line. A tap splitter keeps one

free hose outlet beside the timer for hand-watering and rinsing salt off foliage. Because the tub and dining deck sit 300mm above the low level, all emitters are pressure-compensating. **Does that zoning look right to you?**

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14. The hot tub

Two questions came up about the planting immediately around the tub, and both changed the plant list.

Leaf and petal drop into the water

Everything within reach of the tub is now chosen for what it doesn't shed. M7 and the pots east of the tub are mostly evergreen, tight-habited and glossy or needle-leaved: myrtle, *Hebe*, rosemary, *Convolvulus*, thyme, *Dianthus*, santolina.

Four plants that appear elsewhere in the scheme are **deliberately kept away from the tub**:

Kept away	Why
<i>Erigeron karvinskianus</i>	Flowers for nine months and sheds thousands of tiny spent daisies. The single worst thing you could plant beside a hot tub
<i>Stachys byzantina</i>	The felted leaves rot at the tips and blow about; the flower spikes shed
Lavender	Lovely, but it drops flower debris all through August
<i>Phlomis fruticosa</i>	Sheds large spent flower whorls

Three residual points, honestly:

1. **The olive in M7 will shed some leaf.** Olives are evergreen but drop a proportion of old leaves continuously, heaviest in spring, and they are small and narrow and blow easily. If that would annoy you more than the olive pleases you, **swap it for a second myrtle**. Say the word and we'll re-issue.
2. **Santolina drops yellow buttons** if it is allowed to flower. Shearing the buds off in June — already in the maintenance rhythm — means it drops nothing at all.
3. **The M2(E) olive stands upwind of the tub** on the cold NE spring wind and will shed some small leaf, like the M7 olive. That is the accepted price of standing privacy cover — olive leaves are small, leathery and easy to net off the water, which is why an olive and not (as first drafted) a strawberry tree, which drops soft fruit. Tell us if you'd still do differently.

Bromine, splash and drain-down

Humidity is not the problem; **splash-out and drain-down** are.

- **Never drain or backwash the tub into a planter.** A drain-down is well over a thousand litres of brominated water. It would kill the planting outright and it has no business going anywhere but the terrace drain. Let the

bromine dissipate first if you can.

- **Occasional splash is survivable, and the palette is the right one for it.** Bromine is a salt as well as a biocide, and everything specified around the tub is a coastal plant already adapted to salt spray — rosemary, santolina, thyme, *Hebe*, myrtle, *Convolvulus*. That is not a coincidence; it is why they were chosen.
- **M7 finishes 150mm above the tub rim and sits hard against it**, so it will take both splash and the drips off people climbing out. Set the plants back about 150mm from the face nearest the tub and let the prostrate rosemary take the front edge, where it can cope.
- **Rinse the foliage with fresh water after heavy use** — the same advice as after a salt storm, and it costs nothing.

We'd value the nursery's view on this, particularly on whether the olive in M7 should stay.

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15. Planting, establishment and access

Planting season and the scaffold window

Target: late September – early October. The roof-job scaffold is due down around late September and may be extended to early October (being confirmed) — so the heavy items ride the scaffold hoist or the crane while they still can, and planting follows immediately, with irrigation already live. Brighton's autumn is mild; late-September planting here loses little against October. **Bulbs follow by hand in October–November** — bulb bags carry through the flat easily. Please plan lead times to a firm late-September delivery.

Anchoring the specimens

The seven specimen trees will be planted with **underground rootball anchoring** (Platipus RootBall Fixing or equivalent — three ground anchors and a webbing frame over the rootball, all buried). A 2m evergreen in a 600mm planter at this exposure will rock itself loose in the first winter gale otherwise. No visible stakes.

First-winter and first-spring protection — decided

50% shade netting goes on the N1(E) railings and on temporary posts behind M1(W)'s back row for the **first winter and the first spring** — the establishment insurance on ~£1,900 of specimens, against the winter gales and the desiccating NE winds of March–April. Budget ~£120 in netting and fixings; it comes down as year two opens.

Getting it onto the roof

Three routes, in order of preference:

Route	Suits	Notes
Scaffold hoist (until the scaffold strikes, ~late Sept–early Oct)	The seven specimens, the two bulk bags (gravel, drainage media), the large pots	Builder labour retained under the Phase-1 variation to help set the specimens — a wet 45–60L container is 70–90kg and is a two-person lift full stop
The internal lift + one flight of stairs	Almost everything else — backbone shrubs in trays, all perennials and herbs, bulbs, the small and medium pots	The lift reaches the floor below the terrace; supply in trays or crates so batches carry safely up the last flight
Crane lift (Phase-2 contract lift, date TBC)	Fallback for anything heavy that misses the scaffold window	Must be palletised or caged; secure the rootball , not the stem

What we need from you on delivery:

1. **A firm delivery date**, so it can be coordinated with the builder's lift. A missed crane slot means the specimens have to wait for another one.
2. **Deliver as close to planting as possible** — ideally the day before. Plants must not stand on a scaffold lift for days in summer.
3. **Everything well watered on arrival**, and please flag anything that will need watering in transit.
4. If you can **split the delivery** — specimens and backbone first, perennials and herbs second, bulbs in the autumn — that suits the planting programme better than 200 plants landing on one day.

The client is planting this himself, single-handed, so the phasing above matters more than it normally would. The seven specimens need a second pair of hands — that is retained builder labour, not optimism.

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16. Maintenance, pruning and green waste

Why this shaped the plant list

Green waste is a genuine problem here, not a footnote. Every bag of prunings has to come down through the flat — there is no ground-level access, no bonfire, no compost heap behind a shed. So the scheme was designed to **produce as little of it as possible**:

- **No hedging plants.** Nothing in the scheme is clipped to a shape, other than the two clipped domes; see §2.
- **Naturally small species.** Most of the shrub layer tops out between 60cm and 1.5m of its own accord.
- **Seed heads left standing until February.** *Hylotelephium*, *Eryngium* and the alliums are cut in late winter, not autumn — better for winter structure and for the birds, and by February the material is dry and light rather than green and heavy.
- **Perennials cut at the base**, which produces soft material that composts down to almost nothing.

Rough annual volume, once established: perhaps **300–400 litres loose** of soft prunings and cut-back, plus **100–150 litres** of thin woody material every second or third year when the informal shrubs are reduced. That is an

estimate, not a measurement — but it is a manageable quantity, and it is perhaps a third of what a conventionally planted terrace of this size would generate.

A composter — worth adding

Yes, and specifically a sealed hot composter (HOTBIN Mini, Green Johanna or similar, around 100 litres) rather than an open bin:

- It is **sealed and rodent-resistant**, which matters on a roof beside a dining area and a hot tub, with neighbours below.
- It **doesn't smell** if run properly, unlike an open heap.
- It reduces soft green waste by roughly 90% **in weeks rather than a year**, so it can absorb essentially all the soft material the terrace produces.
- The output goes **straight back as planter top-dressing** — genuinely useful, because container soil loses organic matter steadily and this scheme has 26 m² of it to feed.

Run honestly, two caveats from review: a 100L bin on a cold roof fed only garden waste will stall in winter — **feed it kitchen waste too**; and the February cut-down (~200L in a week) exceeds it — **stage the cut over three or four weeks**. Even so, expect four to six bags a year down the stairs.

Where: the north-east utility corner beside Store 4, screened by the store itself. It is out of the sightlines, next to the tap, and away from the dining and lounge areas.

What it won't take: woody prunings. Those need bagging and taking down two or three times a year — two collapsible garden bags will cover it. Brighton & Hove run a paid garden-waste collection which is worth checking for that residue.

Not recommended: a shredder. Noisy for the neighbours, another thing to store, and the volumes here don't justify it.

Year-round rhythm

When	Job
February	Cut <i>Salvia yangii</i> , <i>Erysimum</i> and all perennials back hard. Now remove the <i>Hylotelephium</i> , <i>Eryngium</i> and allium seed heads. Comb dead leaves out of the <i>Helictotrichon</i> . Cut <i>Atriplex</i> and <i>Elaeagnus</i> hard back. Cut anything that has escaped past the parapet back to the parapet line
April	Slow-release feed (6-month). Light trim of the lavenders — never into old wood. Top up the mulch
June	Cut the spent <i>Euphorbia wulfenii</i> stems out at the base (<i>gloves — the sap is an irritant</i>). Shear <i>Santolina</i> after flowering. Tip-prune the two 'Silver Sheen' specimens, cutting inward
August	Shear lavender and <i>Nepeta</i> after the first flush for a second flowering
October–November	Plant bulbs. Check pot ballast before the winter gales
Never	Prune <i>Cistus</i> into old wood; deadhead <i>Erigeron</i> (let it seed into the paving joints)

Feed lean. Lush growth is exactly what wind and salt destroy, and it is also what fills the compost bin. Hard, well-ripened growth survives and needs less cutting. [↑ Contents](#)

17. The cat

There is a cat, and she has the run of the terrace.

Pot Group E is hers — two low terracotta pans by the study door, beside the litter store she already uses:

- ***Nepeta cataria* — real catnip**, which is far stronger than the ornamental catmints in the beds. It gets its own pan because she will roll on it and flatten it, and it recovers.
- **Cat grass** (*Dactylis glomerata*, or oat or barley grass) — safe to chew, re-sown twice a year, and it is what saves the ornamental grasses from being nibbled.

A cat can't reach into a full-height pot; pans sit at her level, and she will lie in them, which is the point. The thyme she lies on is the N4 mat, an easy jump up.

*(The catmint in the beds — *Nepeta × faassenii* — is much less interesting to cats than true catnip, which is why the beds should survive.)*

On safety. The single most dangerous group of garden plants for cats is the lilies, and **there are no lilies anywhere in this scheme** — none was ever specified, and none should be substituted in. Beyond that:

Watch	Note
All the bulbs — tulip, narcissus, allium, <i>Nerine</i> , cyclamen, snowdrop	Toxic if eaten in quantity. Cats rarely dig bulbs, and the cat grass is there to redirect chewing, but worth knowing
<i>Euphorbia</i> sap	An irritant to cats as to people. Two species here — <i>E. characias</i> and <i>E. myrsinites</i>
Everything else	Nothing else in the scheme is a significant hazard. No yew, no oleander, no foxglove

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18. Where we'd value your expert view

1. **Species choices.** Would you change anything for a fully exposed, salt-blasted roof terrace on the Brighton seafront?
2. **The no-clipping rule (§2).** The shrub palette is restricted to plants that hold their own shape, because no back face can be reached and clippings would fall on neighbours. **Right call, or over-cautious?** *Atriplex halimus* is the one plant that needs an annual cut; keep it or swap it?

3. **M4 at 1m above the rim, and M2(E) north capped at 300mm.** Both are hard client constraints for the Downs view. Does the low planting specified for them read as something, or does it need rethinking?
4. **Supply sizes.** Over- or under-buying? The money is in the specimens; the backbone is bought at 5–10L on the assumption it becomes a functioning windbreak in two seasons rather than four.
5. **Specimens — container or rootballed?** And **lead times** on multi-stem *Olea europaea* at the sizes specified?
6. **N4 is only 400mm deep.** Enough for the herb planting? Would you reduce the drainage layer to gain root run?
7. **Snowdrops.** All 100 are confined to the part-shaded south end, in the green rather than dry, because we think they'd slowly fail in the sunny beds — dormant May to September, and it's the summer bake in lean gritty soil that gets them, which irrigation can't fix. **Do you agree?**
8. **Mulch is gravel collars only** — does the crown-protection reasoning match your experience? **Irrigation is proposed on three zones (§13)** — right split?
9. **The hot tub (§14)** — should the olives (M7 and M2(E)) stay, given they shed leaf?
10. ***Daphne odora* 'Aureomarginata'** is in on sentimental grounds. The sheltered, part-shaded south end gives it a fair chance in a pot. **Realistic, or drop it?**
11. **Green waste (§16).** Does our estimate look right, and would you specify differently knowing every bag of prunings is carried down through the flat?
12. **Winter interest.** Anything obvious missing between November and February in these conditions?
13. **The M2(E) north olive (§5)** — an airy 45–60L multi-stem as a high-level sightline filter ~2m+ above the rim. Will it do that job in year one, and is there a tree you'd rather see there?
14. **The Group C pot olive** wants a clear stem to ~1.2m in a 20–30L — is that a stock item or a special?
15. **Availability check on the three review additions:** *Phillyrea angustifolia* (5L), *Helictotrichon sempervirens* (2L x9), *Elaeagnus x ebbingei* (7.5L).
16. **Anything else you'd tell us that we haven't thought to ask.**

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